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Piedmont Post

A Community Newspaper Serving the Citizens of Piedmont

City welcomes new Planning Director Leslie Mendez

By Jake Lannon

Earlier this year the Piedmont City Council appointed Leslie Mendez as Piedmont's new Planning Director, replacing Kevin Jackson who retired.

Mendez holds a master's degree in City and Regional Planning from the University of California, Berkeley, and a bachelor's degree in environmental studies from Brown University. She is a former planning manager for the City of Albany, a planning manager for the City of San Rafael, and spent 13 years as a planner with the City of Berkeley. Mendez decided she was ready for a new challenge as the director of a city's planning department.



Planning & Building Director Leslie Mendez

"I thought it was an amazing opportunity to become a director in a city," said Mendez. "It's a fun puzzle to apply planning, especially in our current mandates that we're having and how to integrate the values of the community and reflect those values while still meeting state mandates."

Her former boss, Jeff Bond – the retired Community Development Director from the City of Albany – pushed her to take this role after serving as Piedmont's Interim Planning & Building Director.

"My previous boss and mentor acted as interim (in Piedmont), so he was touting the fun it would be for me, and I don't say that sar-

See Leslie Mendez on page 27



Piedmont Play School's new location is at 5000 Clarewood Drive in Oakland, just outside of Piedmont off Harbord Drive.

Piedmont Play School finds new home

By Juliana Weber

Piedmont Play School has officially reopened at its new location at 5000 Clarewood Drive in Oakland, the site of First Church of Religious Science, with a year-round, full-time preschool schedule combined with a co-operative model that allows parents to spend time in their child's classroom.

"We love the co-op model," said Juliana Weber, a continuing school parent. "My husband and I spend two hours a month in the classroom, playing with the kids, reading stories and helping the teachers. You get to see the PPS magic in action. The way the kids interact with each other, problem-solve and light up when they figure something out on their own is truly incredible. It's also given me a real appreciation for what our teachers do every day."

The school will have a new schedule designed to better support working families. School hours will be 9:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. year-round from early August through mid-July.

Longtime teachers Michelle Ritchie and daughter Raven are familiar, trusted faces at the

See Play School on page 27

City Council Candidates – Week 2 Q&A

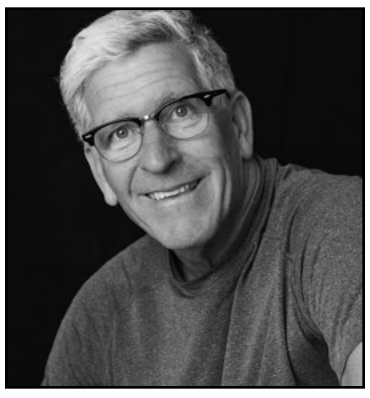
By Jake Lannon

Each election cycle, the *Piedmont Post* provides extensive coverage of each candidate to help residents make informed voting decisions.

For this year's race, the *Post* will send one question to candidates running for City Council every week until election day. The five City Council candidates vying for three open seats received the question on Tuesday, September 2, and were asked to reply with a 200-word response.

Week 2 Question:

What, in your view, are the top 3 issues facing Piedmont? Which issue would you tackle first if elected to the council, and why?



Bill Reichle
(ReichleforPiedmont.com)

There's no shortage of pressing issues facing Piedmont, including Moraga Canyon housing, sustainability, and updating century-old city facilities. I believe voters will appreciate how I evaluate these and other issues by understanding my priorities: public safety, fiscal discipline, and community engagement.

Public safety will always be my top priority. Without it, nothing else matters. Beyond responsive police and fire departments, this also includes public works, emergency preparedness, traffic management, and policy development to mitigate future risks.

Fiscal discipline is my second priority. Without it, nothing else is possible. Piedmont has the

See Candidates Q&A on page 25

Piedmont to host 9/11 ceremony to commemorate 25th anniversary

By Jake Lannon

On Friday, September 11, the City of Piedmont will host a brief ceremony to commemorate the 25th anniversary of the September 11, 2001, terrorist attacks, a defining moment in our nation's history. The commemoration will take place in front of the Fire Station and City Hall and will begin at 8:30 a.m. The event will allow residents to remember the lives lost and honor the service of first responders past and present.

The community is invited to attend and participate in the honoring of the lives lost in the attack. Fire Chief Dave Brannigan and Mayor Betsy Smegal Andersen will give brief remarks to open the ceremony. Following their remarks first responders and attending community members will stand for a minute of silent reflection. The Fire Department will lower the flag at half-mast from sunrise to sunset to mourn the lives lost.



The flag at half-mast at the 20th anniversary event the Piedmont Fire Department held in 2021.

A Celebration of Life is scheduled for John Morrison on Saturday, September 12, at 2 p.m. in the John Morrison Gymnasium at Piedmont Middle School, 740 Magnolia Avenue. The longtime middle school principal died on August 7, 2026, at the age of 84.

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Opinion



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3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610
Phone: 652-2051 • email: news@piedmont-post.com
Publisher & Editor: Gray Cathrall
Executive Editor: Misha Edel
City Editor: Jay Russell

PRODUCTION MANAGER
Victor Cheng

REPORTERS
Jake Lannon
Ed Gilligan

SCHOOLS
Jay Russell

SPORTS
Jonathan Comeaux
B. Durham

PHOTOGRAPHERS
Rob Yelland
Sam Deaner
Brian Mahany
Ken DeCrosta

CARTOONS
Flip - Phil Witte
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Student Writer
Crystal Vadker
Samantha Pell
Mira Sen

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Collecting photos for Where in the World

For 28 years, Piedmont residents have made sure their travels are well documented, with photos of family members reading the *Piedmont Post* in far-off places throughout the world, and some nearby.

The *Post* invites families to send photos with the *Post* from near and far for publication in *Where in the World Are We* on the back page of the paper. With people able to travel once again, there is no better time to have your photo in the *Post.*

Send photos as jpg. files to: news@piedmont-post.com, and be sure to include a brief description of the location where the photo was taken.

Quote of the Week

"The philosophy of the school room in one generation will be the philosophy of government in the next."

– Abraham Lincoln
1809-1865
16th President of the United States

Religion Corner

Of Labor Day and Labor

By Jim Hopkins

Labor Day is a recognition of both the important role labor unions have played in the well-being of our nation and its working families and of the value of work itself.

It is on the value of work, and its corollary, the value of rest, that I would offer a few thoughts.

The creation stories of Genesis celebrate the goodness of the world we inhabit. Included in that goodness are work, toil, labor and rest.

In the first story human beings, having been created in the image of God, are given the work of being fruitful and multiplying, of filling the earth and exercising dominion "over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the air and over every living thing that moves upon the earth."

The questions "How well have we done in the work given us?" as well as "How well are we doing in that work?" are worthy of serious consideration. The answers must include the recognition that the exercise of dominion has often been mistakenly understood as exercise of domination and that our labors have thus undermined, rather than enhanced, the well-being of God's creation.

Still, there is meaning, purpose and joy to be found in "tilling and keeping" the earth, as the second story of creation describes the work we have been given.

Wendell Berry, who died this week at age 92, said it well. "The care of the Earth is our most ancient and most worthy, and after all our most pleasing responsibility. To cherish what remains of it and to foster its renewal is our only hope."

Tilling and keeping the earth takes many forms. As Wendell's life demonstrated, it includes sinking our hands into the soil, putting our hearts into our words, putting our best into our communities and putting our souls into our relationships.

Whether we are employed or not, Labor Day, like the stories of creation and like the testimony of Farmer Berry, reminds us that we, all of us, are here because we have something to give and that there is a time both to give of ourselves, and to rest from giving.

Pastor Jim Hopkins is Pastor Emeritus of Lakeshore Avenue Baptist Church in Oakland.



How to get news in the *Post*

The *Piedmont Post* welcomes its readers to express their opinions on any topic. Columns in the *Piedmont Post* are exclusive and may not be reprinted without permission.

The *Post* reserves the right to edit any pieces or letters submitted. Opinion pieces should be limited to 400 words, letters to the editor to 200 words.

Photo submissions: Please submit photos at 6 inches in width and at a resolution of 200 dpi in jpeg format.

Do you have some news? Send your photos or stories to 1139 Oakland Avenue, Piedmont, CA 94611, or email them to news@piedmont-post.com. It's that easy. (Send us an attachment or cut and paste your text into the body of the email.)

The deadline for submitting news, photos and opinion items is Friday.

League of Women Voters of Piedmont to host forum for City Council candidates on Sept. 29

Join the League of Women Voters of Piedmont (LWVP) on Tuesday, September 29, for a candidate forum. It will feature candidates on the Piedmont City Council ballot in the November 3, 2026, General Election. The forum will be held at 7:00 p.m. in the City Council chambers and in overflow space as needed. It will include the following five candidates running for three positions: Nancy Beninati, Sunny Bostrom-Fleming, Adam Hundt, Tom Ramsey, and Bill Reichle.

Piedmont voters can learn more about the City Council forum at lwvpiedmont.org. Registration is required to attend the live forum, as space is limited. The forum will also be broadcast and recorded on KCOM. After the forum, the recording will be available on LWVP's website, on LWVP's YouTube channel, and through the websites of KCOM and the City.

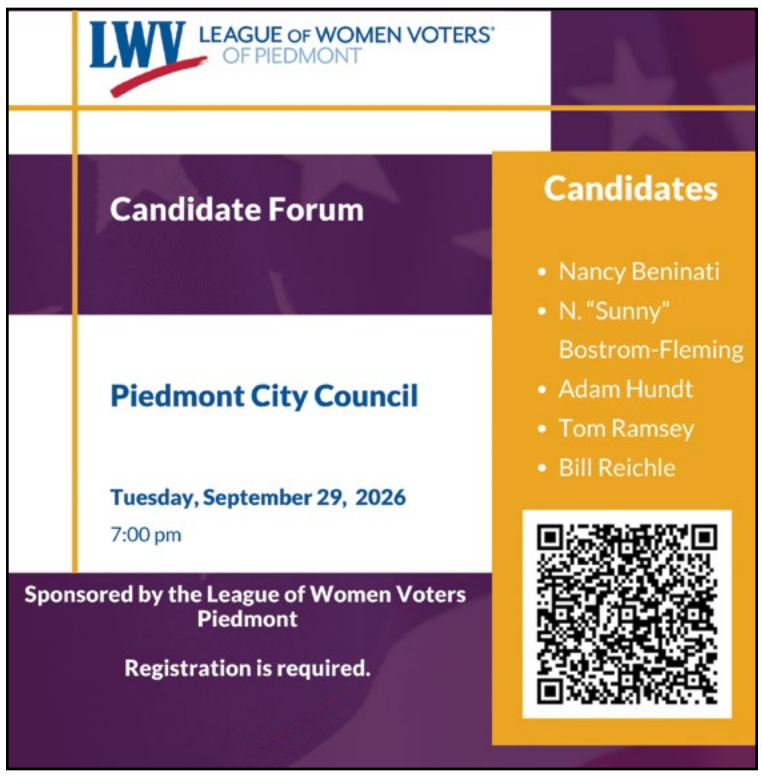
A LWVP representative will moderate the forum. It will include questions from the public. On September 22 until 5 p.m., voters may submit questions by filling out the online form on the event description pages on LWVP's website. Questions will be reviewed to ensure a range of topics and issues.

Visit the Election Resources page (https://bit.ly/4ymy5xS) to learn about WHAT's on your ballot and HOW, WHEN, and WHERE to vote. A ballot will be mailed to every registered voter starting October 5. Ballot drop-off locations will open October 6. If you have moved or changed your party or your name, you can update your registration online. The last day to register to vote is October 19.

There are three ways to vote in Alameda County: 1) mail your ballot, 2) drop off your ballot at a secure ballot drop-box in the county, or 3) vote in person or drop off your ballot at any vote center in the county. The list of vote centers will be updated as the Registrar of Voters confirms the sites. There will likely be a ballot drop-box in central Piedmont next to the mailbox near the Piedmont Community Church. There will likely be a vote center in Piedmont at the Veterans Memorial Building at 401 Highland Avenue.

A limited number of additional early 10-day in-person Alameda County vote centers will also be open starting October 24. A limited number of additional early 4-day in-person Alameda County vote centers will also be open starting October 31. Vote-by-mail ballots must be postmarked on or before Election Day.

The League of Women Voters is a non-partisan political organization. It does not support or oppose any political party or candidate.



Limited-time discounts on rooftop solar and battery storage

For a limited time, Piedmont homeowners can get rooftop solar and battery storage at roughly 15% below average market rates by pooling their buying power with others through the Bay Area SunShares program. Rooftop solar reduces greenhouse gas emissions from your home and saves you money on your utility bill. Battery backups allow you to store energy for later use and can help keep essential devices like medical equipment and refrigerators running during power outages.

SunShares discounts are available for any combination of solar and/or battery storage, either as a standalone installation or an addition to an existing system. SunShares installers offer a variety of financing options, including Power Purchase Agreements (PPAs). For eligible projects, the City of Piedmont's home electrification rebate program can further offset costs.



The rooftops of sustainability award honoree Brandon Bercovich using solar panels.

When you register for SunShares:

1. You'll be contacted by pre-vetted installers selected by an independent evaluation committee.
2. They'll schedule either a virtual roof evaluation or a no-contact site visit to assess your home's suitability for solar.
3. They'll then provide no-cost, no-obligation proposals tailored to your home's needs based on roof type, sun exposure, electricity usage, and other factors.
4. Once you get proposals, you'll have until December 15 to sign a contract with your preferred installer at the SunShares discount rate.

Get more information about the SunShares program and ask questions directly with SunShares pre-vetted solar providers at an upcoming webinar:

- Wednesday, September 16, 6 p.m.
- Friday, October 16, 11:30 a.m.
- Thursday, November 5, 6 p.m.

These one-hour sessions will cover how SunShares works, the basics of solar technology, and financing and incentive options that can be combined with SunShares discounts, with time for Q&A with program staff and installers. To register for the webinar go to https://piedmont.ca.gov/cms/one.aspx?portalId=13659823&pageId=21392900

The City of Piedmont is proud to join over 40 other Bay Area municipalities and employers to support residents' transition to cleaner energy at home by partnering with the SunShares program, which has helped over 1,000 Bay Area households install 5.8MW of solar since 2016.

Visit bayareasunshares.org today to learn more, sign up, and secure your discount. The SunShares program is administered by Act Now Bay Area.

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Local Items

Adoptable Dog of the Week



Jairo is a handsome, 4-year-old German Shepherd mix.

Jairo, pronounced Cairo, is a handsome, 4-year-old German Shepherd mix. He starts his day with bursts of zoomies and playbows, along with a few pets. It's clear to his foster that he was well-loved and cared for by his former family who had to reluctantly surrender him when they lost their housing.

Jairo is proving to be a perfect house guest. He is house trained and non-destructive when left alone. He has great leash manners and knows the sit command. He may become a bit bouncy when he gets too excited with his person, but responds well to redirection. Jairo weighs 80 pounds.

He may be a bit shy and hesitant to interact when meeting new people, but warms up quickly. He is looking for an adopter to continue his journey building trust — someone who can take their time, read his cues, and let him connect on his timeframe. Given his timid nature, he's best suited for an adult-only home or one with older children.

To see a video of him and learn more about him, check out mountainfosters on Instagram. To meet Jairo, submit your adoption questionnaire online on Oakland Animal Services shelter's website and you will be contacted by his foster to arrange a meet-and-greet.

For more information on temporarily fostering a dog or puppy or on adoption, contact Piedmont resident Jessica McDevitt at jessicamcdev@gmail.com.

Adoptable Cat of the Week

By Quinn White



Adopt Denver and Cordelia through Cattown Oakland

Denver and Cordelia quickly decided they belonged together forever, and we have to agree. The two had an immediate connection, and now spend their days cuddling, grooming, and quietly looking after one another.

Denver is a goofy Siamese with a tiny squeak of a meow. He loves lounging on your chest and following Cordelia around. Cordelia is the capable "big sister" of the pair — a floofy tuxedo who gives nose kisses, naps with her chin resting in your hand, and sleeps belly-up with her tongue peeking out. This pair loves to play, often engaging in friendly wrestling matches.

Both cats eat special diets and take daily medication easily, and Cordelia also receives eye drops twice a day. Their foster says, "She is quite used to taking her eye drops and will sit in your lap for them. She's the easiest cat I've ever medicated."

This duo makes those little extra efforts worthwhile — Cordelia is quick to purr and Denver "loves to be taken care of." You simply must meet these affectionate, mellow companions — they're ready to make your house a true home.

Denver and Cordelia are neutered/spayed, vaccinated, and microchipped. Learn more at www.cattownoakland.org or email adopt@cattownoakland.org.

Piedmont Park fencing taken down as city waits for new swings

By Jake Lannon



The new ADA path with wood chips and newly planted grass on either side.

This past week the fencing around the Piedmont Park tot lot has been removed marking the completion of the new ADA path and landscaping. The next stage of the project will include installing new swings and a nature play area funded by the Piedmont Beautification Foundation. According to the city, there is a delay on the manufacturer's end in delivering the new swing set. The city expects the swings to arrive in November.

The new path cuts through the former grassy area between the Exedra Plaza and Piedmont High School campus, connecting with the path in front of the tot lot. Fresh grass has been planted on the left side of the path, while the right side has playground wood chips. The location where the swings will be installed is currently a dug-out hole surrounded by cement stairs with signage and tape to keep the public from entering. The sand surrounding the area has been removed and will be replaced with ADA fiber matting.

During installation of the new swings, the climbing structure, lawn area, Exedra Plaza, and restroom will remain open. The memorial benches are within the construction zone and will be reinstalled after the project is completed.

Modernscape Innovations was awarded the $156,364 contract to complete the first stage of this project. The swing equipment and ADA fiber matting installation is anticipated to be awarded separately via a California Multiple Award Schedule (CMAS) agreement. The swings will be bucket swings similar to the original swings. Once the equipment arrives in November, installation will take two weeks to complete.

This project is in response to the longstanding community request to rebuild the swings that were removed in 2024 due to structural rot. The current plan is to expand the swing zone to meet modern safety requirements.



The dug-out area where the new swing equipment and ADA fiber matting will be installed.

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How these residents helped bring a pool to Piedmont

By Jake Lannon

More than 25 years ago, a few community members dedicated themselves to bringing a new pool to Piedmont. Josh Bernstein, Russ Hafferkamp, and Clarence Mamuyac identified the community's need for aquatics and worked to bring a new pool to the city and schools.

"There just wasn't enough pool space," said Bernstein. "Piedmont was and is still one of the only school districts in our area that doesn't have their own swimming pool."

At first, the group wanted to help the School District build a pool on campus, but were eventually shot down due to the School District's concern over liability and maintenance. They decided to set their sights on the Piedmont Swim Club pool.

"It became apparent that we had a much broader interest in aquatics in Piedmont than the pool (Piedmont Swim Club Pool) could really sustain. We had a new developing water polo team, we had a really good high school aquatics program, and there was a growing number of new families that wanted to have the same aquatic experiences that were available in Orinda, Lafayette and Moraga," said Hafferkamp, then the assistant coach of Cal's water polo team.

At the time, the Swim Club's Pool was unfit to host aquatic sports. It was considered a "relic," and the group believed it needed to be addressed. They proposed renovations to accommodate aquatic sports and expand space for swimmers.

"We contacted Clarence Mamuyac, who was a very active architect in the aquatics field and lived in the community, and he was supportive of the idea. He helped us build a 3D model of what the facility would look like with drawings and renderings, and we had a series of public meetings and public presentations inside the community about our plan," said Hafferkamp.

Not everyone was supportive of this plan to renovate the pool and there was pushback from the leaseholders of Piedmont Swim Club.

"We were met with equal parts opposition, equal parts support, and equal parts apathy.

"Apathy kind of won the day," said Hafferkamp.

"The problem was the Piedmont Swim Club. They had the lease from the city on the pool, and they didn't want to make any changes. What they had done at the time was remove the gutters from the old Piedmont pool during a renovation project, which rendered the old swimming pool unfit for swimming competition," Bernstein explained.

"They were trying to force the swim teams out, and it worked. They couldn't hold swim meets at the old Piedmont swim club. That became a problem because we had the swim team here in town, and the kids were working out in this substandard pool. They (Piedmont Swim Club) were afraid they were going to lose their swim club, and they wouldn't have any place to swim during construction."

Their project and ideas were shut down. It took years before the community would think about a new pool again. It was only when the swim club lost its lease to the city that the idea of a new pool gained traction.

"Eventually, they lost their lease, and that's when things started to change. Once the Recreation Department (under Mark Delventhal) took things over, there was an opportunity," Bernstein said.

There was a community movement of those who recognized the value of aquatics; many of whom were previously against the idea of a pool were now on board.

"The community recognized the future value of aquatics, and the reality that the old pool was a relic and needed to be addressed," said Hafferkamp.

A new pool was approved, and after years of planning and construction, the Community Pool was built. Bernstein and Hafferkamp believe the work they did with Mamuyac paid off.

"I think that the homework that we did in the beginning helped when Betsy Andersen came along, and she was able to really take it from this concept that we had to a real project," said Bernstein.

He and Hafferkamp were very appreciative of the work Mayor Andersen and the city did to bring this project to fruition. When Bernstein showed up for the pool's opening day, he reflected on the years of hard work his group put into the idea of a new pool. Seeing it completed was an emotional moment for him.



Josh Bernstein gives a thumbs-up on the opening day of the Community Pool.

"I got choked up on the first day when we came to go swimming. It was such a long time coming. To see that concept that started in our kitchen become a reality and such an unbelievably impressive reality. It was an emotional experience for me," said Bernstein.

The two plan to enjoy the new pool for as long as it exists.



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Schools

School Board meets tonight

By Jay Russell

Piedmont's School Board will convene for a regularly scheduled meeting on Wednesday, September 9 at 7:00 p.m. in City Hall. Interim Superintendent Dr. Donald Evans will preside over his first meeting since rejoining the district in August.

Evans' return to start the school year has stabilized things in the district so that August could be about new teachers and new classes.

The school board will announce its plans to begin the search for a new superintendent by submitting a request for proposals (RFP) from education executive search firms or individuals to provide consulting services for a national search.

The board aims to publicly announce the new superintendent by December 9, 2026.

The permanent role of superintendent would start on January 1, 2027.

Teachers, parents and students have benefited from Evans' steady hand.

"I can't believe some of the high school students remember me from four years ago. To hear them say 'welcome back, Dr. Evans' made me feel like I was back home," Evans said.

The meeting will feature a check presented to the board by the Piedmont Education Foundation. The Parcel Tax Committee is also slated to be recognized by the board. The presentation of the evening will put Beach Elementary School in the spotlight as Principal Anne Valva talks about test results, and the school culture in 2026.

This school board meeting will be held at City Hall, 120 Vista Avenue and can be seen remotely at Zoom.us/wc/83297005216 and on KCOM local Channel 27.

Thinking Outside the Classroom

Welcome to KidNuz

Good morning and welcome to KidNuz. Today is Wednesday, September 9th, 2026 and we begin with…

A sacred piece of 9/11 history now on the final leg of its cross country journey. Organized by the son of a fallen New York firefighter, the 21-foot long, 16-thousand pound steel beam from the South Tower of the World Trade Center made 35 stops in 21 states to help kids better understand the magnitude of that day in 2001… and ensure future generations "Never Forget" the souls lost and the sacrifices made. This Friday, it will join a procession through the Brooklyn-Battery Tunnel as part of remembrances marking the 25th anniversary of the attacks. The beam's final appearance will be at the Giants-Cowboys game at MetLife Stadium on Sunday. For more on the impact of the tour and the importance of learning about 9/11, check out a special episode we dropped last weekend. You can find it wherever you get your podcasts.

Sticky fingers have struck France… again. Early yesterday, thieves stole four paintings by the famed artist Renoir from a small museum on the French Riviera. The escape wasn't flawless; the burglars dropped two of the paintings during their getaway. Still, the ones they did make off with… are worth millions. The brazen theft comes less than a year after the high profile heist of crown jewels from the Louvre in Paris, many of which are still missing.

Are you ready for some football? The NFL is back — and not just with any game. Tonight, for the first time in a decade, the season is opening with a Super Bowl rematch: It'll be the Seahawks vs the Patriots, with New England quarterback Drake May hoping to avenge the 16 point drubbing by Sam Darnold last February. For celebration, and perhaps emphasis, the Seahawks will raise their championship banner just before kickoff, which is 5:20 p.m. Pacific Time.

A famed US landmark has gone to the birds, at least temporarily. As it does every September, the Gateway Arch in St. Louis, Missouri is turning off its lights at night to keep our fine feathered friends from getting sidetracked as they head south for winter. According to the National Park Service, the arch sits smack dab in the middle of one of the nation's busiest bird highways: the Mississippi Flyway. Many of the avian aviators travel at night and the lights can be disorienting, sending them in the wrong direction or, sometimes, even into the sides of buildings. Come October, once most of the birds have safely winged their way to warmer destinations, the Arch will light back up, before bowing to nature again in May for their long return trip home.

If only all elections could be this friendly. When a recent town council showdown in Arizona ended in a 67-to-67 tie, local officials turned to a century old state law to break it: a game of chance. It could be any game, like rock paper scissors, marbles or straws, but Gila Bend decided its two candidates would draw cards, high card wins.

And it's a good thing they considered the possibility of another deadlock, because — improbably — both candidates drew 3s. It was pre-determined that spades would trump other suits, which one of the two wanna-bees had and clinched the win. Gila Bend is far from the first town to decide a race by chance. According to the New York Times, local elections have come down to poker games, straw-drawing and, earlier this month in Hawaii, names tucked into plastic eggs and picked from a woven basket.

In KidNuz Business Notes:

The big reveal from Apple is now just hours away. At 10am Pacific time, at an event called "Surprise and Shine," the company is expected to take the wraps off a foldable iPhone, which would be the biggest redesign since its release in 2007. How much for the latest and greatest? The best guess from analysts is 2-thousand dollars, which is twice the cost of the current top-of-the-line iPhone.

And.. Spidey is swinging from webs of money. His latest film, "Spider-Man: Brand New Day" held on to the top spot at the box office over the holiday weekend, marking its sixth straight week at #1. So far, the movie's made 2.4 billion dollars worldwide and capped a really good summer run for Hollywood, which saw domestic ticket sales up more than 22-percent over last summer.

Still to come: if you like ice cream — and honestly who doesn't — we have found what could be the perfect job.

But first, today's KidNuz Quiz:

- *Why was a beam recovered from the ruins of the World Trade Center taken around the country?* To make sure future generations "Never Forget" the events of 9/11
- *Thieves in France stole museum paintings by what artist?* Renoir
- *Which teams are playing the first game of the NFL season?* The Seahawks and Patriots, a Super Bowl rematch
- *Why is St. Louis' famous arch dark for the month of September?* So its lights don't distract birds flying south for winter

In today's KidNuz Kicker:

Your chance to scoop for Snoop. Rapper, singer, and all-around businessman Snoop Dogg is hiring what could be everyone's dream job: International ice cream taster. The pay: $10,000 a month for three months of globetrotting in search of the latest, greatest and wackiest frozen concoctions.

Ultimately, the goal is to help Snoop pick out his next 'flavor.' Do you have what it takes? The job requirements include speaking English, a valid passport, and the availability to travel for the next three months. Not mentioned, but probably obvious: Those who are lactose intolerant need not apply.

Loving KidNuz? New episodes drop every weekday morning at 7am.

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PHS class of 2006 celebrates 20-year reunion

By Drew Preston

Calling all faculty and staff of Piedmont schools, as well as Rec. Dept. and other community members who overlapped with the class of 2006.

All former faculty and staff are welcome to help the PHS class of 2006 celebrate this milestone by joining for their 20th reunion on campus.

The Class of 2006 will celebrate their 20-year reunion on Friday, September 18.

- **4:30-6:00 p.m.** — Meet & Greet at the Piedmont High Student Center on the Quad. This will be a casual, fun get-together for students and faculty/staff to catch up and reminisce. At least a few dozen students have confirmed their excitement and attendance.
- **7:00 p.m.** — PHS Homecoming Football Game at Witter Field. Join us for continued conversation as we cheer on the Highlanders.

For more info and questions, please reach out to Drew Preston, Class President (Andrew.Preston5@gmail.com; 510-410-1851).

READ IT IN THE *POST*

FUN4KIDS Event Calendar

By Jay Russell

Children's Fairyland
Fairyland.org
699 Bellevue Avenue, Oakland 452-2259

The park is open Wednesday-Sunday; and select Tuesdays during September. Park hours are 10:00 a.m.-4:00 p.m. Fairyland has just the right stuff to spark a child's imagination. From the rides to the petting zoo and Alice in Wonderland maze, a day of fun is a few blocks away from Piedmont. All shows on the stage of Fairyland's Storybook Puppet Theater are original productions, featuring scripts, costumes, music, and sets designed by their talented puppeteers. Check website for show schedules and special events.

Chabot Space & Science Center
Chabotspace.org
10000 Skyline Boulevard, Oakland 336-7300

Chabot is now open Wednesday-Sunday, 10:00 a.m.-5:00 p.m., for a full day of fun and exploring the out of this world exhibits. Older kids will love the shows in the planetarium and megadome, the boldest way to experience space and science, on the biggest of big screens. Every Friday and Saturday night the Chabot Observatory Deck has a free telescope viewing 7:30-10:30 p.m., as well, weather permitting, check their website for visibility status. Cleardarksky.com/c/ChbtSPCCAkey.html?1

Pacific Pipe Climbing Gym
Touchstoneclimbing.com/pacific-pipe
2140 Mandela Parkway, Oakland, 903-6722

Pacific Pipe Climbing Gym is the perfect space for rock climbing excitement and instruction kids love. Are your kids stuck inside and bouncing off the walls at home? Take them somewhere where they can literally climb the walls. The expansive space has 46,000 square feet of climbing, with enormous climbing walls up to 55 feet and many programs for climbers of all ages and skills. It is also a great place to host a birthday party. Pacific Pipe has extensive hours of operation seven days a week.

Peek-A-Boo Factory
Peekaboofactory.com
5411 Geary Blvd, San Francisco (415) 230-5188

An indoor children's entertainment center in San Francisco that offers walk-in play at all times, with ball pits, monkey bars and padded multi-story play zones for kids. The space has age-specific play areas and obstacle course that will have kids thinking they are competing in Ninja Warrior. Check the Peek-A-Boo Factory's site for children's parties, or impromptu fun. Open seven days a week. New locations are also open in Daly City, Livermore and Rancho Cordova.

Girl Scouts Ice Cream Social at Piedmont Park

By Carolyn Pan

On Sunday, August 23, more than 100 Girl Scouts and their families gathered in Piedmont Park to kick off the new scouting year at the annual ice cream social and sing-along.

The ice cream social was hosted by Head-Royce and Piedmont High School tenth grade Senior Troop 33587, who served scoops of vanilla, chocolate, and rainbow sherbet with a variety of toppings, including sprinkles, whipped cream, crushed Oreos, and chocolate chips.

While enjoying their ice cream on the lawn, PHS twelfth grade Ambassador Troop 30713 led the girls in singing traditional Girl Scout songs. This year's sing-along was the final time for these Ambassadors to host the yearly tradition before they graduate.

The Ambassador Scouts belted out classic camp tunes, starting with "Make New Friends" and diving into lively repeat-after-me songs like "There Was a Great Big Moose." The younger scouts were invited to lead the group with songs they picked like "Over the Deep Blue Sea."

Service Unit 303 Girl Scouts gathered in a friendship circle to close the event as the girls are ready for a year of building courage, confidence and character.



Girl Scouts kicked off the new scouting year with an ice cream social and sing-along event in Piedmont Park.



Lucy Allen (front left), Jeannie Choi, Skye Prata-Baack, Kate Tong and Emma Chan; Charlotte Phung (back left), Junie Worthen, Maya Evans, Victoria Mbise, Sicheng Wu.



Girl Scouts from Piedmont, Oakland, and Emeryville end the event with a friendship circle.

Piedmont Adult School fall registration still open

Registration is underway for the Fall 2026 session, with classes beginning September 14. Piedmont Adult School offers a wide range of community classes designed to make learning enjoyable and accessible for adults of all ages.

Whether you want to explore a big idea, discover a new practice or simply taste some really good chocolate, there's still time to join us and learn something new and valuable this fall.

Spaces are still available for classes including:

- **Understanding Modern Art** — Make more sense of what you see in museums and galleries! Explore the artists, ideas and movements that shaped modern art and learn some of the vocabulary that can make looking at and talking about art more enjoyable. No previous art background is needed.
- **Philosophy as a Way of Living** — Explore how ideas from some of the world's great philosophical traditions can help us think about the questions that matter in everyday life, from our values and choices to what gives life meaning.
- **Mindfulness in Motion: Zen and the Japanese Sword (Budo Zen)** — Discover a different approach to mindfulness through movement. This class combines Zen meditation with Iaido, a classical Japanese sword art practiced with bokken (wooden swords). Through guided sword movements, concentration and meditation, you'll explore ways to develop greater focus, awareness and inner calm. No martial arts or meditation experience is necessary.
- **Wild Chocolate: Taste the Amazon** — Taste four premium chocolates made from sustainably sourced Amazonian cacao and discover how where cacao grows influences its flavor. A certified chocolate taster will guide you through the tasting while sharing the story of chocolate that supports rainforest preservation and local communities.
- **Eat for Your Body Type** — Learn more about your individual body type and explore how making thoughtful food choices can support your health and well-being.

Come learn something new, expand your horizons, and meet great people at Piedmont Adult School this fall! Register today at piedmontadultschool.org or call 510-594-2655 for more information.



Fall classes begin September 14, registration is now open.

ADVERTISE IN THE *POST*

Girl Scouts backpack to Point Reyes

By Carolyn Pan

Sophomore Girl Scout Troop #33587 started their scouting year by camping for two nights at Point Reyes the last weekend of August. They started at the Palomarin Trailhead and hiked 5.5 miles in with an elevation gain of about 1,000 feet to Wildcat Campground. This was their 24th camping trip as a troop and the longest backpacking hike so far.

The hike took the girls past Bass Lake and through forests lit by the setting sun. The girls arrived at the campsite in the dark and were greeted by the moon rising over a ridge and Venus glowing in the west over the Pacific Ocean. By day, the girls were visited by a fox, an elk and flocks of California Quail.

The girls also earned merit badges by drawing in nature as part of the Mind, Body badge.



Girl Scouts in Troop #33587 take the Palomarin Trail towards Wildcat Campground in Point Reyes. Pictured are Victoria Mbise (left), Emma Syhabout, Juliette Edesses and Charlotte Phung.



Victoria Mbise (left), Charlotte Phung, Emma Syhabout and Juliette Edesses stop for a photo as the sun sets over Bass Lake.



Troop #33587 leader Stacy Readall looks south from Point Reyes with the setting sun highlighting the Pacific Ocean.



Juliette Edesses (left) and Emma Syhabout *Photos by Carolyn Pan*



Troop #33587 backpacked 5.5 miles to reach Wildcat Campground in Point Reyes.



A gray fox walks by Piedmont Girl Scouts during their backpacking trip in Point Reyes.

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STREET SWEEPING SCHEDULE – 2026-27

Street sweeping is critical for keeping storm drains clear during leaf drop season. Residents should move cars and any other obstacles blocking access to the curb off the street on street sweeping days.

September 7 - September 18

Mon.	Tues.	Wed.	Thur.	Fri.
September 7	8	9	10	11
Holiday	**2-Odd**	**3-O**	**4-O**	**5-O**
September 14	15	16	17	18
1-Even	**2-E**	**3-E**	**4-E**	**5-E**

E = Even Street Numbers O = Odd Street Numbers

Streets, by Zones — **Indicates streets where both even and odd addresses are swept on "even" days*

ZONE 1
Ashmount Ave
Cambrian Ave
Cavanagh Ct *
Crest Rd
Crocker Ave
(South of La Salle Ave)
Croydon Circle *
Estates Dr
Florada Ave
Glen Alpine Rd
Hampton Rd
(East of Sea View Ave)
Huntleigh Rd
Indian Rd
Indian Gulch Rd
Inverleith Terr
La Salle Ave
La Salle Ct *
Lafayette Ave
Lexford Rd
Marlborough Ct *
Muir Ave
Sandringham Pl
Sandringham Rd
Sea View Ave
(Between La Salle & Crocker)
Selborne Dr
Somerset Rd
Sotelo Ave
St James Circle
St James Dr
St James Place
Trestle Glen Rd
Tyson Circle
Valant Place
Wildwood Gdns
Wistaria Way
Woodland Way
Wyngaard Ave

ZONE 2
Arroyo Ave
Bonita Ave
(North of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(West of Grand Ave)
Estrella Ave
Grand Ave – *ODD*
(Bet Wildwood & Cambridge)
Grand Ave
(Between Cambridge & Rose including Lower Grand)
Greenbank Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Holly Place
Howard Ave
Kingston Ave
Lake Ave
Linda Ave
Lorita Ave
Lower Grand Av
Manor Dr
Monticello Ave
Nace Ave
Oakland Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Olive Ave
Park Way
(Between Monticello & Bonita)
Parkside Dr *
Ramona Ave
Ronada Ave
Rose Ave
Sunnyside Ave
York Dr

ZONE 3
Arbor Dr
Artuna Ave *
Blair Ave
(Below Highland)
Bonita Ave
(South of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(East of Grand Ave)
Carmel Ave
Dale Ave
Dracena Ave
El Cerrito Ave
Fairview Ave
Grand Ave – *EVEN*
(Between Wildwood & Cambridge)
Greenbank Ave
(East of Grand Ave)
Highland Ave
(North of Mountain Ave)
Highland Way
Hill Lane *
Hillside Ave
Hillside Ct **(Hand Blow)*
Jerome Ave
Keefer Ct *
Larmer Ct *
Latham St
MacKinnon Pl *
Magnolia Ave
Moraga Ave
(West of Highland)
Nova Dr
Oakland Ave
(Between Grand & Highland)
Park View Ave
(Between Magnolia & 241 Park View)
Park Way
(Between Bonita & Highland)
Ricardo Ave
San Carlos Ave
Sylvan Way
Vista Ave
Waldo Ave

ZONE 4
Abbott Way *
Alta Ave
Bell Ave
Bellevue Ave
Blair Ave
(Above Highland)
Blair Place *
Calvert Ct
Craig Ave
Dormidera Ave
Dudley Ave
Dudley Ct *
Echo Lane *
Hagar Ave
Hardwick Ave
Langdon Ct *
Littlewood Dr
Maxwelton Rd
Mesa Ave
Monte Ave
Moraga Ave
(East of Highland)
Mountain Ave
(West of Sharon)
Nellie Ave *
Oakland Ave
(Between Highland & Scenic)
Pacific Ave
Pala Ave
Park Way
(Between Highland & Pala)
Scenic Ave
Sharon Ave
Sharon Ct

ZONE 5
Annerley Rd
Boulevard Way
Caperton Ave
Crocker Ave
(North of La Salle Ave)
Crofton Ave
Farragut Ave
Guilford Rd
Hampton Rd
(West of Sea View Ave)
Harvard Rd
Hazel Lane
Highland Ave
(South of Mountain Ave)
King Ave
Lakeview Ave
Lincoln Ave
Mountain Ave
(East of Sharon)
Oak Rd
Oakmont Ave
Palm Dr
Park Lane
Park View Ave
(Between 241 Park View & Winsor)
Piedmont Ct *
(Hand Blow)
Poplar Way
Portsmouth Rd
Prospect Rd
Ranleigh Way
Requa Pl
Requa Rd
Richardson Way
Sea View Ave
(Between Mountain & La Salle)
Sheridan Ave
Sierra Ave
Wallace Rd
Warfield Ave
Wildwood Ave
Winsor Ave

Subscribe to *Street Sweeping Email Updates* (https://lp.constantcontactpages.com/su/2tJcrMR/streetsweepalerts) to get reminders about upcoming street sweeping dates. The Piedmont Public Works Department sends out the weekly schedule to this list every Sunday during street sweeping season.

Street sweeping tips for residents

To help Piedmont's Department of Public Works keep the streets free of leaves during the fall and winter months, residents are asked to observe four rules:

1. Do not put branches in the street, even small branches! They damage the street sweeping equipment.
2. Do not sweep debris from your yard into the gutter – sweep only leaves that fall naturally into the street.
3. Sweep leaves into narrow rows outside the flow line of the gutter. Do not put them in piles. The street sweepers cannot pick up piles of leaves effectively.
4. If you want to rake your leaves, you can now add them to your weekly unlimited green waste cart. If you don't have enough room in your cart, free compostable bags are available at City Hall to place with your green cart on garbage day. Do not bag them and then empty the bags on the street on sweeping day. Compostable bags are also available from Republic Services (1-800-320-8077) for a fee.



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www.piedmontfuneralservices.com
5000 piedmont ave., oakland, ca (fd#2210)

PPD Blue

Excerpts from the Piedmont Police Department Log

Aug. 28 - Sept. 4

The Week by the Numbers
1 Assault
1 Residential Burglary
1 Hit & Run
1 Fraud Report
2 Reports of Vandalism
3 Auto Burglaries
5 ALPR triggered (Automatic License Plate Readers)

Friday, August 28

1:44 p.m. Pala Ave. **Auto Burglary.** Report of 2012 Subaru broken into. Damage unknown..

4:56 p.m. Waldo Ave. Report of gas-powered leaf blower in use. Verbal warning issued.

5:55 p.m. San Carlos Ave. **Residential Burglary.** Report of electric scooter stolen from driveway overnight. $500-$1000 loss.

10:30 p.m. Croydon Circle. Report of subjects being loud in backyard. People taking it inside.

Saturday, August 29

5:38 a.m. Highland Ave. **Auto Burglary.** Report of window smashed on van; tools stolen.

3:22 p.m. Grand Ave. **ALPR** triggered by blue Honda CRV.

3:26 p.m. Kingston Ave. **ALPR** triggered by vehicle with tags for Porsche.

5:21 p.m. Estates Dr. **ALPR** triggered by vehicle with lost or stolen plates driving on wrong side of the road.

8:42 p.m. Highland Ave. **Assault.** Report of physical altercation at Veterans Hall. Officers find 50-60 individuals outside in verbal altercation following fight involving many individuals. PFD provides first aid. One teenager taken to hospital for small contusion. How altercation started still unclear; follow up in progress.

Sunday, August 30

1:43 p.m. Arbor Dr. **Auto Burglary.** Window smashed on white EBMUD truck. Glove box rifled through.

Monday, August 31

10:42 p.m. Oakland Ave. **Fraud.** Report of credit cards opened in resident's name.

3:45 p.m. St. James Dr. **ALPR** triggered by white Honda Civic.

8:54 p.m. Grand Ave. **ALPR** triggered by vehicle with plates from 2013 Audi.

Tuesday, September 1

5:41 p.m. Hillside Ave. **Vandalism.** Report of broken basement door.

Wednesday, September 2

1:28 p.m. Park View Ave. **Hit & Run.** Report of white work van striking another car. Video surveillance submitted.

3:36 p.m. Nace Ave. Report of juvenile skunk stuck in rat trap. Animal Control takes skunk to Lindsay Wildlife Center.

Thursday, September 3

7:30 a.m. Grand Ave. **Vandalism.** Report of person pulling down partitions and traffic cones. Subject has shopping cart. Officer attempts to make contact, person runs away. No pursuit & no damage.

9:28 a.m. Abbott Way. Shotgun and ammo turned in to PD for destruction.

11:24 a.m. Nace Ave. Report of another skunk stuck in rat trap. Animal Control able to release skunk from trap.

Friday, September 4

8:18 a.m. Crocker Ave. Report of silver Toyota Corolla crashed into garbage dumpster.

PICK OF THE WEEK

• *Burning Man? No, no, just a road trip.*

Saturday, August 29

2:07 a.m. Oakland Ave. Report of subjects working on beach cruiser bicycle in driveway. Officer finds two subjects packing vehicle for road trip.


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Sports

Boys' water polo team plays first match at new Piedmont Pool



Piedmont High hosted its first water polo match since 2019 on September 3 against James Logan. *Staff Photos*

By Jonathan Comeaux

Thursday, September 3 was a monumental day for Piedmont High's water polo team. The boys' team hosted James Logan HS at the Piedmont Pool for a regular season match, marking the first time the team has done so since 2019.

The Highlanders fell in double-overtime 8-7 to the Colts, but the game result hardly impacted the team's joy on Thursday night. For people who have been connected to the program, like coach Rik Krumins who was an assistant coach on that 2019 squad, playing at home was an emotional experience.

"We all worked so hard for this. I love this sport, and the fact we're here is kind of weird. There are a lot of people who put blood, sweat, tears into this facility. One thing I talked with the team about was past teams were literally knocking on doors to tell people," Krumins said.

Piedmont's current players were in elementary school the last time the school hosted a water polo match.

"Tonight means a lot to everyone. We've had to commute long distances for practice, but the team has so much passion and everyone was willing to do it. This is definitely going to help get more people involved, younger people involved, and grow the program," senior Colin Amen said.

The Highlanders' match against James Logan was a battle of two D2 North Coast Section qualifiers, and Thursday certainly had a playoff atmosphere.

According to online records, Piedmont High has never hosted a playoff game at the Piedmont Pool. Before the closure, PHS received high playoff seeds from 2016 to 2019, but still played each match at pools outside Piedmont. For this year's team, hosting a NCS match would be a major step forward.

"It would mean so much to host a playoff game. Having that crowd really riles us up; it takes the intensity to a whole new level," said junior Rylan Patty.

"I've rarely heard a home crowd before. It's great; I tried to get a lot of my friends to come out here. A lot of people don't know how big water polo is to our community, but it's a big sport in Piedmont. We have an awesome culture and it's nice to share that with people," Colin Amen said.

Hearing a home crowd at

See Boys' Water Polo on page 23



Rylan Patty scores one of his three goals against James Logan.

Piedmont blanks St. Mary's for first win of season

Rehan Mumtaz totals 180 yards on offense

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's football team captured its first win of the season with a 28-0 shutout of St. Mary's at Witter Field on Friday, September 4. It was a strong defensive day for the Highlanders who had five quarterback sacks, four tackles for loss, and an interception.

It marked the school's first shutout since October 2024 when they beat Dougherty Valley 41-0.

"We probably could've played a cleaner game, but it's hard to complain about a 28-0 shutout. The defense played really well, so it was good to see them rallying around and tackling. We're a young team, and momentum is big for a young team, so now it's about keeping the guys focused," Coach Jordan Seiden said.

It was a good response for PHS following its season-opening loss to Napa, where the winning side gained 314 yards on the ground.

"During practice this week, we knew we had to work on the run game. We knew that if we stopped the run, we'll be able to defend the pass and we really trust our pass coverage. We really just worked on defending the run so we can force them to pass," senior linebacker Colby Hong said.

Senior running back Rehan Mumtaz had his way with the Panthers' defense, switching the field and putting opposing players on skates. He recorded 130 rushing yards on 12 carries, to go along with three receptions for 50 yards and two touchdowns.

"We usually start off the season pretty slow, but once we find our zone, things really get going. Our line blocked so well today, I can't give enough gratitude to them. Running becomes instinct at this point, I've practiced so many times that finding the lanes becomes second nature," Mumtaz said.

Game Recap

St. Mary's opened the game with a long drive down to Piedmont's nine-yard line, but their series stalled on 4th-and-4. The Highlanders turned over on downs at their own 41, but wasted no time getting the ball back. On the Panthers' first play, Piedmont's Owen Curran intercepted a long pass at their own 12 with 20 seconds left in the first quarter.

See Football on page 23



Staff Photos

Diego Hurwitz (2) celebrates a touchdown with Henry Brennan (6) and Mason Gray (28).



Rehan Mumtaz during his 35-yard touchdown reception against St. Mary's. He had two touchdown catches, 130 rushing yards, and 50 receiving yards.

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Piedmont volleyball improves to 10-4



Piedmont has boosted its record to 10-4 overall. *Staff Photos*

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' volleyball team split its last two matches over the past week. They shut out Redwood Christian 3-0 on Tuesday, September 1 at Binks Rawlings Gym Two days later they fell to Salesian 3-2 in a heated five-set match bout 3-2 at Salesian in Richmond.

The results improves Piedmont's record to 10-4 overall, which eclipses last year's total of nine wins.

"When we're at our best, we're getting pressure from all three hitting spots. It starts with our middles and opens up. We continue to see them just getting better," co-head coach Mike Glass said.

Despite the loss to Salesian, outside hitter Maika Ting had a strong performance, logging a season-high 24 kills.

"Maika's been super consistent and has shown great improvement in terms of knowing when to take a little bit off and when not to," Glass said.



Fiona Olsen led Piedmont with seven kills against Redwood Christian.

3-0 over Redwood Christian

It was a clean 3-0 sweep for Piedmont over the Eagles, winning by scores of 25-9, 25-14, 25-14.

In the first set, PHS established an 18-5 lead at one point, including two kills by Maika Ting, Sofia Meyer, and Charlotte Bailey. Fiona Olsen and Lucia Dorsey also had individual kills and blocks.

Piedmont continued the momentum into the second set, leading 9-0 until Redwood Christian got its first point. The run included three aces by Carina Vora, a block by Dorsey, and another kill by Olsen. RCHS inched closer to make it a 12-7 deficit, but PHS extended to 24-12 from there before the Eagles added two more points.

Both teams traded points in the third set with PHS leading 5-4. From there, Piedmont scored seven straight points to lead 12-4. The Highlanders extended the lead to 22-7 before Redwood Christian inched closer to 24-14. PHS closed the game with a thunderous kill by Olsen.

Final stats: Olsen recorded seven kills and one block. Ting recorded four kills, six digs and two assists. Bailey recorded two kills. Allyson Huynh recorded one kill, five digs and one assist. Izara Dando recorded two kills. Hazel Schaeffer recorded one ace and five digs. Meyer recorded four kills, two aces and three digs. Nora Trombi recorded two kills, one ace, two digs and seven assists. Olivia Stevens recorded five kills, one ace and three digs.



Maika Ting had 24 kills against Salesian.

Dorsey recorded four kills and two blocks. Vora recorded five aces, one block, six digs and 15 assists. Mia Bechtel recorded two aces, six digs and four assists.

3-2 loss to Salesian

Piedmont won the second and fourth sets, Match scores were 25-19, 18-25, 25-19, 24-26, 15-12.

In the fourth set, both sides traded the lead multiple times until PHS built a 22-18 cushion. However, the Pride went on a four point run to tie it at 22-22. PHS had set-point at 24-23, but an error tied things up. After that, Piedmont scored two straight with a kill by Dorsey and a lane violation by Salesian to force a fifth set.

Salesian took control in the fifth set to hold match-point at 14-9, but PHS scored three straight to make things interesting at 14-12. To end the match, Salesian called the number of its tall middle hitter, finishing with a spike.

Final stats: Ting recorded 24 kills, six aces and eight digs. Bailey recorded five kills, two blocks and one dig. A. Huynh recorded 35 digs and 11 assists. Dando recorded four kills. Meyer recorded eight kills. Stevens recorded five kills, and five digs. Dorsey recorded five kills, three blocks and three digs. Vora recorded two aces, 20 digs and 26 assists. Bechtel recorded nine digs and 11 assists.

Tuesday vs. San Leandro

Piedmont hosted San Leandro on Tuesday, September 8 for its first Western Alameda County Conference match of the season. See next week's *Post* for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (10-4 overall) visits San Marin in Novato on Thursday, September 10 at 6:30 p.m.

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Cross Country places 8th, 10th at St. Mary's Invitational

By Jonathan Comeaux



Alex Schleuning led the way for Piedmont, finishing 26th of 178 runners.

Piedmont High's cross country team traveled to Moraga for the St. Mary's Invitational at St. Mary's College on Saturday, September 5. The boys team came away with an eighth place finish out of 25 schools, while the girls placed 10th of 24 teams.

"Overall, it looked like what it was – the first race of the season," said coach Steve Zirkelbach. "We saw a lot of good things, but we also learned some things about how we need to race better. We had runners who were aggressive early, but had a harder time maintaining that momentum through the second mile."

Senior Alex Schleuning led the way for the Highlanders in 26th of 178 runners in 10:47.02 on the two-mile course. Piedmont's top-four runners were separated by just 14 seconds. Dresden Schulte-Sasse was next in, finishing 36th in 10:51.57. Sophomore Dylan Wallway was 46th in 10:58.79, senior Aaron Bennett was 53rd in 11:01.35, while sophomore Blake Riiff rounded out the top five in 113th in 11:59.60.

"Alex, Dresden, Dylan and Aaron were separated by only 14 seconds. Having four runners that close together gives us a really good group to work with as we continue building toward the championship portion of the season," Zirkelbach said.

The girls' squad was notably without three top runners, seniors Leighton Mand and Amalia Gray, and sophomore Kelsey Coleman. Sophomore Camille Hauser led the team placing 46th of 166 runners in 13:19.95.

"Camille Hauser ran 13:42 here last year, so she improved by approximately 23 seconds from her freshman season," Zirkelbach said.

Piedmont had all five of its best runners within 53-seconds of each other. Right behind Hauser was senior Cora Brozowski-Schrader in 47th with a time of 13:21.42. Junior Nikita Gorelik finished 55th in 13:29.41, fellow junior Viviane Oesterer was 69th in 13:50.26, while sophomore Madeleine Ewen rounded things out in 83rd in 14:13.06.

"We have always put a lot of emphasis on developing a strong pack rather than relying on one or two runners at the front, and this gives us a good group to continue developing," Zirkelbach said.

See Cross Country on page 23



Dresden Schulte-Sasse was second in for PHS, placing 36th. *Staff Photo*



Camille Hauser (1048) led the girls' varsity team, finishing 46th of 166 runners.

Flag Football team splits two games

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's flag football team split its last two games, bringing their record to 2-5 overall. The Highlanders claimed a narrow 14-13 win over San Leandro at Witter Field on Thursday, September 3, and lost 38-0 to St. Ignatius of San Francisco at home on Saturday, September 5.

Saturday's game against St. Ignatius was Piedmont's inaugural "Battle of the Bay" Highlander Showcase, which featured four games where one East Bay school took on one school from San Francisco.

"A tournament like this is really good because we're playing and watching more football. We've installed a lot in a little bit of time, so we're looking forward to seeing how things look at the end of the season with the experience we've gained," said defensive coordinator Hayley Adams, who filled in for coach Beth Black on Saturday.

"This tournament means we're taking this sport seriously. When the program started four years ago, it wasn't very serious at first. Now, we're here to play football and win games," said quarterback Edie Elmquist.

Against the San Leandro Pirates, PHS held an initial 8-0 lead after Agatha Filha-Gama recorded a safety late in the first quarter before Edie Elmquist hit Cea'naiya Alexander for a seven-yard touchdown midway through the second. San Leandro scored to end the first half.

"Naiya was on the outside and was open in the corner. We're moving the ball well; we're working on blocking, seeing what the defense is doing, and then figuring out how that affects our plays and what we do," Elmquist said.

The Pirates went ahead 13-9 late in the third quarter, but Piedmont found the winner late in the game. Nearing the final minute of action, running back Nea Mafi made the play of the game. With the ball at SL 26, Mafi took an initial run to the left side, but turned the other direction with defenders converging on her. Using her speed, Mafi sprinted the opposite way to avoid pressure, evaded one defender, and then broke to the end zone to make it 14-13.



Staff Photos

Nea Mafi scored the game-winning touchdown against San Leandro on an improvised 26-yard cutback run.



Kate Tong had one interception and three pass defenses against San Leandro.

14-13 over San Leandro

After back-and-forth possessions through the first quarter, Piedmont pinned San Leandro deep with a punt late in the first quarter. It led to Filha-Gama recording a sack in the end zone to give her team a 2-0 lead.

Piedmont took over at their 25 midway through the second for its next score. Elmquist converted a critical 3rd-and-7 with an eight yard quarterback keeper, while Mafi later converted a 3rd-and-3 with an eight yard carry. On 3rd-and-goal from the SLHS seven, Elmquist stepped back for pass, initially looking left before turning to the right to find Alexander running a corner route for the touchdown, making it 8-0.

San Leandro scored on its ensuing possession on 4th-and-goal from the 19 to end the quarter down 8-7.

In the third quarter, San Leandro drove all the way down to Piedmont's three, but the Highlanders held them without a touchdown. SLHS scored to end the third quarter after starting possession at Piedmont's 25, scoring after four plays to go up 13-7. PHS had a chance to score after an interception by Kate Tong started a series at the Pirates' 19, but Piedmont stalled out at the 23 following a penalty.

Piedmont's game-winning score came on the third play of its series. At the San Leandro 26, Mafi took a handoff to the

See Flag Football on page 28



Cea'naiya Alexander had a touchdown reception against San Leandro.

JV loses to Casa Grande, but encouraging performance



Ernie Hildreth (1), Mateo Morgan (33), Will Dietrich (5), and Koli Faotusia (71) *Photos by Graham Smith*



William Bridges (4) Jeb Burden (81) Jojo Logwood (28)

By Robby Koch

Although the Highlanders conceded a 26-13 loss to Casa Grande last week, their performance gave Highlander fans hope. The defense was quite strong and the offense picked up towards the end of the game.

The Highlander defense came out in the first drive on fire. They set the tone on the first play of the game with a ferocious tackle for loss by Lethi Havea setting the Gauchos back 3 yards.

The bottom line for the offense in the first half was turnovers. With two costly fumbles early in the game, the Gauchos put Piedmont on their heels with a passing TD and one touchdown on a run.

With the Highlanders needing to score to stay alive, freshman Will Dietrich showed his speed and agility, taking the kickoff 70+ yards and putting the Highlanders in a prime position to go into halftime with some momentum. Along with his long kickoff return.

Dietrich put the Highlanders in great position on just about every kickoff when he touched the ball despite playing with an injury.

A combination of smart coaching by head coach Pouyan Assadi and quick runs by Ernie Hildreth enabled the Highlanders to convert on a fourth down with two seconds left in the first half. With an extra point by Gael Fierro the halftime score was 20-7.

Special teams player Jojo Logwood came in with a full head of speed from the linebacker position and was able to block two CG extra points.

With the Highlander defense trying to set the tone like they did in the first half, things were looking up as two penalties against Casa Grande's offense resulted in a first and 25 on their own 20-yard line. But two miscues by Piedmont's defense allowed a 23-yard catch, followed by a quarterback scramble to pick up the first down.

It didn't take long for the Gauchos to rip off a 54-yard touchdown run, the third TD of the game. With a Logwood extra point block the score was 26-7.

Piedmont dominated the fourth quarter. Playing in Petaluma against a strong opponent, Piedmont showed grit and determination on both sides of the ball.

Offensively, quarterback Gio Lopez led a commanding final drive, which ultimately resulted in a perfectly placed pass to wide receiver Gael Fierro on a slant route resulting in a touchdown. Fierro would go on to be the team's leading receiver.

The culmination of the fourth quarter came from a pass breakup by freshman Sebby Joseph. Coming to the team a little later than everyone else, he's shown quick improvement.

Injuries included severe leg cramping by linebacker and running back Ernie Hildreth, sidelining him for the rest of the game. Lev Keluva was pulled sharply while blocking on a Piedmont kick return, tweaking his back, but he was later able to return. Finally, freshman Will Dietrich came down hard on the ball after running for 70+ yards and needed a short break.

Next week

Piedmont will face a manageable opponent – Salesian High School – at 4 pm on Friday September 11 at Witter Field.



Gio Lopez (25)

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Students, families, and faculty were on-hand at Piedmont High's first home water polo match since 2019.

Sights from water polo's first match at Piedmont Pool

Piedmont High hosted its first water polo match since 2019 on Thursday, September 3 when the Highlanders welcomed the James Logan Colts. All photos were taken by the *Post's* sports editor, Jonathan Comeaux.

Comeaux's photos throughout the school year are available for purchase. Contact Jonathan at JonathanCX525@gmail.com to discuss photo packages of your athlete.



Travers Kemp gears up for a shot against the Colts.



Rylan Patty sends a shot during an overtime match against James Logan.



Graham Smith sends a lob pass against James Logan.



Piedmont coach Rik Krumins calls out instructions during Piedmont's match with James Logan.



Dylan Jerez tosses in a pass against James Logan.



Walker Wilson sends a shot against James Logan.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

PIEDMONT SPORTS SCHEDULE

Some events subject to change. (Revised - 9/9/26)

Date	Day	Sport	Opponent	Loc.	Var.	JV.
Sep. 9	Wed.	TEN	Albany	H/A	3:30	3:30
		GG	Castro Valley (Redwood Canyon GC)	A	3:30	3:30
		WP-B	Clayton Valley	H	4:30	3:30
Sep. 10	Thurs.	VB	San Marin (Novato)	A	6:30	5:30
		FF	Tennyson	H	7:45	6:45
Sep. 11	Fri.	FB	Salesian	H	7:00	4:00
Sep. 12	Sat.	XC	Ed Sias Invitational (Martinez)	A	8:30	8:30
Sep. 15	Tues.	TEN	Lick-Wilmerding (San Francisco)	A/H	3:30	3:30
		WP-B	Alameda	A	4:45	5:45
		VB	Acalanes	H	6:30	5:30
		FF	Hayward	A	7:30	6:30
Sep. 16	Wed.	TEN	Berkeley	H/A	3:30	3:30
		GG	Berkeley, San Leandro at Lake Chabot Golf Course	A	3:30	3:30

KEY: H = Home, A = Away, XC = Cross Country, FB = Football, FF = Flag Football, VB = Girls' Volleyball, WP-B = Boys' Water Polo, TEN = Girls' Tennis, GG = Girls' Golf

Arts & Entertainment

Berkeley Playhouse presents *Legally Blonde The Musical* Sept. 11 - Oct. 11

By Allyson Aleksey

Berkeley Playhouse opens its 2026-27 season with *Legally Blonde The Musical*, based on the popular 2001 film, running September 11 through October 11.

The production stars Ayani Dorsey as Elle Woods, a sorority president who enrolls at Harvard Law School after being dumped by her boyfriend and ultimately proves herself while working on a case.

No'eau Kahalekulu directs the production, with choreography by Cat Delos Santos Reyes and music direction by Camden Daly. The production features a 25-person company of Bay Area performers.

"If you loved this movie in 2001, I promise it's even more fun with a live band and an audience. The show moves at a whip fast pace and is full of laughs and seriously impressive dance and vocals," said Kimberly Dooley, Artistic Director of Berkeley Playhouse. "*Legally Blonde* defies stereotypes and celebrates female teamwork, empowerment and above all else...authenticity."

Kahalekulu said the character of Elle Woods has remained a favorite since the film's release.

"Elle Woods has been my comfort character since 2001. If she can get into Harvard and keep her sparkle, the rest of us can handle whatever's in front of us," said director No'eau Kahalekulu. "We've all gotten a little scared to be big and silly and sincere in public lately. This production is an invitation back into it. Like the show says, being true to yourself never goes out of style."

Scenic design is by Sarah Phykitt, with costumes by Ashley Renee and lighting by Sophia Craven. The musical is based on the novel *Legally Blonde* by Amanda Brown and the 2001 film of the same name.

The cast also includes two dogs: Latke the Pomeranian, making a theatrical debut as Bruiser Woods, and Stella, a three-year-old French bulldog mix, as Rufus.

Tickets are available through Berkeley Playhouse online at https://berkeleyplayhouse.org/.



The production stars Ayani Dorsey as Elle Woods.

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SF Opera performs free concert in Golden Gate Park this Sunday

By Allyson Aleksey

San Francisco Opera will celebrate the opening of its 104th season with the 51st annual *Opera in the Park*, a free outdoor concert this Sunday, September 13, at Robin Williams Meadow in Golden Gate Park.

The concert begins at 1:30 p.m. and will feature the San Francisco Opera Orchestra conducted by Music Director Eun Sun Kim, along with singers from the company's upcoming 2026-27 season.

Scheduled performers include sopranos Eleonora Buratto, Sofia Gotch, Mary Hoskins, Toni Marie Palmertree and Heidi Stober; tenors Joshua Guerrero and Christopher Sokolowski; baritones Amartuvshin Enkhbat, Thomas Mole and Gabriel Natal-Báez; and bass-baritone Christian Van Horn. The program will include arias and ensembles by composers including Verdi, Puccini, Donizetti, Glinka, Weber and Richard Strauss, as well as a selection from a movie musical.

San Francisco Opera General Director Matthew Shilvock will emcee the concert.

The event, presented by the *San Francisco Chronicle*, typically draws more than 10,000 people to Golden Gate Park. Established in 1971 by former Opera General Director Kurt Herbert Adler, *Opera in the Park* has featured performers including Luciano Pavarotti, Montserrat Caballé, Marilyn Horne and Renata Scotto.

A picnic contest, introduced last year, will return, with judges selecting the best-decorated or most elaborate picnic spread during the first half of the concert. Food and beverages will also be available for purchase.

Children and families can visit Bearitone the Opera Bear's Club House for coloring, crafts and lawn games. The event is free and does not require tickets.

For more information, call (415) 864-3330 or visit sfopera.com/operainthepark.



The free concert is held at Robin Williams Meadow in Golden Gate Park. *Photo courtesy of San Francisco Opera*

Oakland Ballet's *Luna Mexicana* at Paramount Oct. 30 & Nov. 1

Presale tickets available online now



Ramona Kelley in Oakland Ballet's performance *Luna Mexicana* *Photo courtesy of Oakland Ballet*

By Allyson Aleksey

Oakland Ballet Company will perform *Luna Mexicana*, a ballet celebrating Día de los Muertos and traditional Mexican dance, on October 30 and November 1 at the Paramount Theatre in Oakland.

Luna Mexicana is an original work by Oakland Ballet Company's Artistic Director Graham Lustig and is one of the Bay Area's most celebrated events honoring Día de los Muertos, or Day of the Dead, a holiday celebrated and observed mostly in Mexico and Latin America.

Lustig's production features a young woman whose ancestors "dance" back to life in the form of teetering skeletons, skirt-swishing ladies and a bride and groom duet. In 2018, Oakland Ballet Company premiered *Viva la Vida,* co-choreographed by Lustig and Martín Romero of Ballet Folklorico Mexico Danza. The dance celebrates the life and artistry of iconic Mexican artist Frida Kahlo, and is now included in annual presentations of Luna Mexicana.

The program is presented in two acts with an intermission, and features a selection of Mexican contemporary and folkloric dance as well as music curated by Lustig. Past performances have included the Aztec ensemble Nahui-Ehekatl and Co. and dancers from Ballet Folklorico Mexico Danza.

Audience members of all ages are encouraged to attend in Day of the Dead costume. *Luna Mexicana* is a family-friendly event and ideal for audience members ages 7 and up.

Tickets are available online now. Visit https://oaklandballet.org to purchase tickets.

Kent Nagano returns to Berkeley Symphony podium in Oct.

Berkeley Symphony opens its 2026–27 season with *Inheritance* on Sunday, October 18, 2026, at 4 p.m. It marks the return of Music Director Laureate Kent Nagano to the orchestra for the first time since 2009. Held at the Henry J. Kaiser Center for the Arts (10 10th St, Oakland), the season-opening concert brings together works by Felix Mendelssohn and the world premiere of Vater unser by Argentine composer Alex Nante, a work dedicated to Berkeley Symphony and Nagano.

The program opens with Mendelssohn's *The Hebrides (Fingal's Cave)*, followed by the premiere of *Vater unser*. Pianist Mari Kodama then joins the orchestra for Mendelssohn's *Piano Concerto No. 1*. The program concludes with Mendelssohn's *Symphony No. 5, "Reformation,"* whose finale is built on the chorale "Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott."

"In *Vater unser*, Bach's melodies become a point of departure for an unbound process of orchestral amplification and harmonic elaboration," said Nante. "One of my main interests as a composer is the evocation of light in sound, whether in meditative or ecstatic atmospheres." Nante began his series of Bach-inspired works at Nagano's encouragement, as the composer and conductor have collaborated frequently in recent years.

Nagano led Berkeley Symphony for 31 years, from 1978 to 2009, shaping the orchestra into an internationally recognized ensemble known for adventurous programming and commitment to living composers. His return to the podium reunites Nagano with an orchestra whose artistic identity he helped define for more than three decades.



Photo by Antoine Saito

Conductor Kent Nagano is renowned for interpretations of clarity, elegance, and intelligence, with a repertoire spanning the classical, romantic, and contemporary eras.

"As Berkeley Symphony looks toward its future, it is especially meaningful to welcome Kent Nagano back to the orchestra he helped shape," said Berkeley Symphony Executive Director Marion Atherton. "Kent remains a wonderful friend and champion of Berkeley Symphony, and we're delighted to have him with us for this season opener. His return connects us to the orchestra's history while reminding us that an inheritance is not simply something to preserve – it's a foundation to build on as we imagine our future."

Berkeley Symphony's 2026-27 season features three Mainstage Concerts and two Chamber Concerts, including two premieres. The next Mainstage Concert features Berkeley-born composer Gabriella Smith's *Desert Ecology*, a response to the realities of climate change, on February 27 and 28, 2027. Following orchestra tradition, living artists make up over half of the season's composers.

Subscription packages and individual tickets are on sale now, with single tickets starting at $20. The season offers a full subscription (all three mainstage concerts plus both chamber concerts) and a mainstage subscription (all three mainstage concerts). Tickets are available at berkeleysymphony.org or by phone at (510) 841-2800.

Mathias Kauage exhibition now on display at de Young



Photo by Gary Sexton

Installation view of *Contemporary Painting in Papua New Guinea: Mathias Kauage and His Family*.

By Allyson Aleksey

A rare and unique exhibition featuring artwork by contemporary Papuan artist Mathias Kauage is on display at the de Young, one of the fine arts museums of San Francisco, now through December 6.

Kauage is regarded as the leading figure of contemporary art in Papua New Guinea. He exhibited internationally in Europe, America and Australia regularly before he died in 2003. The local exhibition features four paintings from the de Young's permanent collection by Kauage and his family, on view for the first time.

Born in 1944 in a village in Papua New Guinea's remote highlands, the artist moved to Port Moresby, the country's capital, as a teenager. He began drawing at a young age when he was inspired by the work of Timothy Akis, the first Papuan artist to hold a western-style exhibition. Under the mentorship of German artist Georgina Beier at the National Arts School in Port Moresby, Kauage began to develop his own distinctive style and find his preferred medium of acrylic on canvas. He also learned and mastered printmaking techniques, woodcuts and copper-beating.

Kauage is most famous for his acrylic on canvas paintings and murals, which are highlighted in this exhibit. His works famously focused on how technology has impacted life in remote Papua New Guinea, and his later works addressed societal issues such as the onset of the HIV/AIDS epidemic. In the late 1970s, Kauage and his wife Elisabet led the contemporary arts movement in the newly independent Papua New Guinea.

His works are in the National Gallery of Australia, the National Gallery of Papua New Guinea, the British Museum and the Gallery of Modern Art in Glasgow, but are less often on display in western museums, making the de Young's exhibition a rarity.

To learn more, visit https://www.famsf.org/exhibitions/papua-new-guinea-mathias-kauage.

Autumn Lights Festival returns to Lake Merritt Oct. 15 - 17

By Allyson Aleksey

Autumn Lights Festival, an art-filled and family-friendly fundraising event for the Friends of the Gardens at Lake Merritt (FGLM), returns this year on Thursday, October 15.

Now in its 15th year, the three-night festival brings illuminated art installations to the gardens surrounding Lake Merritt. The event has drawn more than 12,000 visitors since its launch in 2012.

This year's festival will feature more than 50 illuminated art displays throughout the gardens, along with live entertainment, an art market, children's activities and food and beverage vendors. Additional activities include a costume contest for children and adults, an artists awards program and a kids zone. The festival's food court will feature local food trucks and vendors, along with beer and wine gardens.

Proceeds from ticket sales benefit the Friends of the Gardens at Lake Merritt, a nonprofit volunteer organization formed in 2004. The organization works with the City of Oakland to support the maintenance, revitalization and programming of the gardens at Lakeside Park.

The seven-acre collection of themed gardens includes the Bonsai Garden, Sensory Garden, Toddler Garden and Urban Edible Garden, among others.

FGLM volunteers provide maintenance assistance as the city's gardening staff has been reduced over time. The Autumn Lights Festival is the organization's largest annual fundraiser.

Tickets and additional information are available through the Friends of the Gardens at Lake Merritt at https://gardensatlakemerritt.org/about/.



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The Musical Gourmet

Art needs nuance

By Joseph Gold

Where would the world be without nuance? Truly great art has nuance. That is one of the important ingredients. Picture a field of grass. It is green. But no two blades of grass have the same hue of green. Music used to require nuance. Now, thanks to pop music's obsession with the electrical amplification, nuance has been relegated to the dictionary. It simply has ceased to exist. How sad.

The reality of this was driven home to me in two pops-type concerts last week. A word of explanation is needed here.

Many years ago, I knew one of the important Spanish diplomats of the 20th century. He was the Duke of Baena, and even though I knew him very well I always referred to him as "Your Excellency." The Duke's diplomacy was one of his strong points. One time he had a heated meeting with Generalissimo Franco. Diplomacy probably saved him from execution. I need his advice now on how to answer my opinion of pop music.



José María Ruiz de Arana y Bauer(1893-1985) was known as the Duke of Baena. He was a respected diplomat from Spain and a knowledgeable musical historian. His Excellency was a longtime friend of mine, and taught me the art of diplomacy.

One famous musician of the past responded by saying: "I like some of it very much."

The two concerts I attended were Tom Rigney's fiddle concert with his ensemble known as Flambeau, and a concert entitled "Paris in Piedmont" presented by SonoMusette.

The music was worlds apart, but the concerts shared many things in common.

Each ensemble was thoroughly professional. They love to perform. It was most enjoyable to see their seamless timing as they moved from one musical selection to another. The mature audience was appreciative and enthusiastic from the outset. It is very gratifying to see things like this. But there was one drawback.

Both concerts were so loud that the music was deafening. The volume was artificially created by artificial amplification not artistic ability. As I said before, the audience loved everything. It didn't matter that they were becoming deaf. They loved it all. I, however, value my hearing and decided to depart. The music was still audible through closed doors while I was across the street.

MOVIE REVIEW

Extremely Loud & Incredibly Close a work of art



Thomas Horn and Tom Hanks in *Extremely Loud & Incredibly Close*

By Chris Honoré

On September 11, 2001, four commercial airliners were hijacked by al-Qaeda terrorists. Two crashed into the twin towers of the World Trade Center, one into the Pentagon, and one was brought down in rural Shanksville, Pennsylvania, by the extraordinary will of the onboard passengers. Known simply as 9/11, it is a day that will forever be remembered and memorialized.

The moving and heartfelt film *Extremely Loud & Incredibly Close* opens with what has become an iconic image of 9/11: the falling man. We bear witness to an individual dropping some 106 stories through the air, unable, we assume, to escape a consuming fire and so chooses this unimaginable final outcome.

Another image captured in the film, one that will forever be with us, is the scene of a brick wall. It's only been a few days since the Twin Towers collapsed. In the dark of night the camera slowly moves from right to left, revealing countless photographs of the missing, along with hand-written messages, many a desperate plea to call home. At the foot of the wall are lighted candles and bouquets of flowers. In essence, the wall is a heartbreaking memorial to those who will likely never return, but we fear are lost forever amid the rubble and steel that now lies where the towers once stood.

But there is more to this haunting and extraordinary film, one that tells the story of a nine-year-old boy, Oskar Schell (Thomas Horn), who lost his father on what he refers to as "the worst day."

School had let out early on Tuesday, September 11, for reasons that are initially unclear to Oskar. He arrives home, and as usual checks the family's message machine. Unexpectedly, message one is his father's voice (Tom

See Loud & Close on page 23

PIEDMONT CENTER FOR THE ARTS

Welcome to the Piedmont Center for the Arts

Ongoing through September 20
Book Club Art Show Gallery Hours

This eclectic group of artists, ***The Book Club at Van Kleef's***, first met at Café Van Kleef in Oakland in 2005. Their show, *For the Love of Art*, includes works of 19 artists. Open Gallery Hours from 11 a.m. – 2 p.m. on Saturdays and Sundays through September 20. The show is free and open to all!

Saturday, September 12, 6:30 p.m.
Cuban Fusion Illustrated Book Talk

Most people know the iconic voice of the Queen of Salsa, Celia Cruz, one of the world's greatest ambassadors of Cuban music and culture, but what happened to Cuban music after successive waves of migration carried Cuban musicians, artists, and cultural producers across the globe? In this talk, **Dr. Eva Silot Bravo** examines how the fall of the Berlin Wall, the collapse of the Eastern socialist bloc, and Cuba's economic crisis of the '90s reshaped the trajectory of Cuban music. Drawing on the research behind *Cuban Fusion: The Transnational Cuban Alternative Music Scene* (Palgrave Macmillan, 2024), the presentation traces the evolution of trans-national Cuban jazz and fusion scenes over the past three decades, reshaping Cuban music into a truly global phenomenon. Reserve your seat for this fascinating event at https://www.ticketsignup.io/EvaBravo.

Sunday, September 13, 7:00 p.m.
Temescal String Quartet Concert

A San Francisco Bay Area classical ensemble established in 2004 by professional musicians from the San Francisco Opera and Ballet Orchestras, founded by *violinist* **Barbara Riccardi**, the group will perform quartet masterworks by Mozart, Ravel, and the US premiere of a quartet by Jane O'Leary. Barbara will play alongside **Dana Myers**, *violin*, **Linda Green**, *viola*, and **Nancy Bien**, *cello*. Light refreshments will be available after the performance, and advance tickets are now at https://www.ticketsignup.io/TSQ.

Sunday, September 20, 4:00 p.m.
Marcio Candido solo violin Concert

Award-winning Brazilian violinist **Dr. Marcio Candido**, who has performed worldwide as a soloist, chamber musician, concertmaster, and educator, will perform a program of 75–80 minutes of music that offers a strongly compelling musical journey, from the profound introspection of J. S. Bach's *D Minor Partita* and its monumental *Chaconne*, through the radiant brilliance of the *E Major Partita*, to the architectural grandeur and triumphant conclusion of the composer's *Third Sonata*. Recognized for his expressive artistry and versatility, Dr. Candido has appeared in major concert halls and music festivals around the world, and currently serves as Chair of the Music Department at Weimar University in California. Light refreshments will be offered, and advance tickets are now available online at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Candido.

Saturday, September 26 to November 1
Oakland Art Association gallery show

Oakland Art Association presents *"Hopes and Dreams"* — a curated show that encompasses everyone's most precious and intimate desires for the future. OAA is a non-profit group of artists, photographers, and art supporters in Alameda and Contra Costa Counties whose mission is to encourage artistic endeavor in the community, support public school art education, and arrange show venues for our members' artworks. The Opening Reception at PCA will be from 1:00–4:00 p.m. on Saturday, September 26, and is free and open to all!

Saturday, September 26, 6:00 p.m.
Ezequiel Barrera and Carl Blake piano recital

As part of his residency in the SF Bay Area, virtuoso pianist and composer **Ezequiel Sebastian Barrera** from Mexico City will perform a recital, assisted by local *pianist* **Carl Blake** in a performance of Barrera's *Fantasia Mexicana* for four hands, one piano. Ezequiel has performed extensively to critical acclaim in diverse venues around the world including US, Canada, Mexico, Central America, Chile, and Germany. The program includes works by Beethoven, Ravel, and Villa-Lobos as well as original compositions by Barrera. A wine reception will follow the recital to which everyone is cordially invited. $25 Advance tickets are available at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Barrera.

801 Magnolia Avenue • Piedmont, Calif.
info@piedmontcenterforthearts.org
www.piedmontcenterforthearts.org

PIEDMONT CENTER FOR THE ARTS

801 MAGNOLIA AVENUE, PIEDMONT, CA

PRESENTS THE

TEMESCAL STRING QUARTET

performing quartets by *Mozart*, *Ravel*, and the US premiere of a *Jane O'Leary* composition!



Dana Myers, *violin*



Nancy Bien, *violoncello*

Linda Green, *viola*



Barbara Riccardi, *violin*



SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

7:00 P.M. (Doors open 6:30)

STAY FOR LIGHT REFRESHMENTS WITH THE ARTISTS AFTER THE CONCERT!

PLEASE BE SURE TO PURCHASE YOUR ADVANCE TICKETS AT:

https://www.ticketsignup.io/TSQ

PIEDMONT CENTER FOR THE ARTS

801 MAGNOLIA AVE., PIEDMONT

PRESENTS:



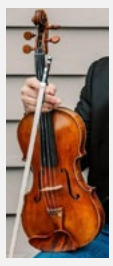
MARCIO CANDIDO

Extraordinary violinist! Internationally acclaimed award & prize-winner!

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 20, 2026

4:00 P.M. (DOORS OPEN 3:30)

Johann Sebastian Bach (1685b1750) is vital because he perfected Baroque music, mastered counterpoint, and built the foundation for all Western harmony. He combined deep emotional power with extreme technical skill, creating timeless works that have guided the development of modern classical music. This concert will feature selections from Bach's *Sonatas* and *Partitas*.



Stay after for light refreshments!

PLEASE BUY ADVANCE TICKETS AT:

https://www.ticketsignup.io/Candido

PIEDMONT CENTER FOR THE ARTS

801 MAGNOLIA AVENUE, PIEDMONT, CA 94611

PRESENTS INTERNATIONALLY ACCLAIMED

EZEQUIEL S. BARRERA

PIANIST & COMPOSER FROM MÉXICO!

ASSISTED BY CARL BLAKE, *PIANO*

PROGRAM:

Impressões Seresteiras - **Heitor Villa-Lobos**

Piano Sonata No. 23 in F Minor Op. 57 "*Appasionata*"- **Ludwig van Beethoven**

Fantasía "IRINI" - **Ezequiel S. Barrera**

Fantasía Mexicana - **Ezequiel S. Barrera** (Piano duet with Carl Blake)

LIVE – IN PERSON



SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 26, 2026

6:00 PM (DOORS OPEN 5:30)



These two amazing musicians have each performed all over the world to great renown and invite you for a special evening of wonderful chamber music. Light refreshments will be available following the performance.



For $25 advance tickets, please visit: https://www.ticketsignup.io/Barrera

FESTIVAL OPERA

SALON SERIES

AT PIEDMONT CENTER FOR THE ARTS



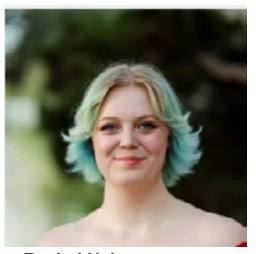
Resident Artist Showcase

Sunday, September 27, 2026

(Doors open 7:00) 7:30 PM *note evening start time!*



Marielle Leiboff, soprano



Rachel Nelson, soprano



Phoebe Dinga, mezzo-soprano



Spencer Greene, tenor



Liam Daley, baritone



Daniel Lockert, pianist

Celebrate the launch of Festival Opera's new Resident Artist Program with a concert of arias and scenes featuring the exceptional talents of our inaugural class of resident artists.

(SUBSCRIBE TO SAVE $25 ON SERIES)

BUY TICKETS At: https://tinyurl.com/FestivalSalon1

SEE www.festivalopera.org for more program details when available

FEATURES



The Wine Corner

Chappellet: A Napa Valley pioneer on Pritchard Hill

By Pierre DuMont

High above Napa Valley, on the rugged slopes of Pritchard Hill, Chappellet Winery occupies a place that is both physically and historically distinctive. Founded by Donn and Molly Chappellet in 1967, the family winery was one of the pioneers of Napa Valley's modern wine era and helped establish mountain vineyards as a source of some of California's most distinguished Cabernet Sauvignon.

Donn Chappellet came to winemaking with an ambitious goal: to produce wines that could stand alongside the great First Growths of Bordeaux. After selling his interest in a successful food-service company, he and Molly moved their family to Pritchard Hill, then an isolated and largely unproven piece of Napa Valley. Following the advice of legendary winemaker André Tchelistcheff, they planted vines on the steep, rocky terrain.

It was hardly an obvious choice. Pritchard Hill is considerably warmer and more rugged than much of the valley floor, with elevations at the Chappellet estate ranging from about 800 to 1,800 feet. But those difficult conditions turned out to be an advantage. The thin, well-drained soils and varied elevations and exposures naturally limit vine vigor and produce small quantities of intensely flavored grapes. Today the estate is divided into 48 vineyard blocks, each reflecting differences in soil, slope and exposure.

Chappellet's first commercial Cabernet Sauvignon appeared in 1969, establishing a tradition that remains at the heart of the winery. Although the original vineyards also included Chenin Blanc, Riesling, Chardonnay, Gamay and Merlot, Cabernet Sauvignon gradually became the estate's signature. The winery's Pritchard Hill Cabernet Sauvignon is now its flagship wine, produced from the finest fruit on the mountain.

The winery itself is almost as memorable as the wines. Built in 1968, the unusual pyramid-shaped structure was designed by artist Ed Moses and architect Dick Keith. Partly hidden among the trees, it has become one of Napa Valley's most recognizable winery buildings. Wine writer Hugh Johnson once called it "the most remarkable wine cathedral of the modern world."



The cathedral-like interior of Chappellet Winery

Chappellet remains family owned, with the second generation carrying on Donn and Molly's vision. Winemaker Phillip Corallo-Titus, who returned to Chappellet in 1990, has guided the estate's winemaking for decades, emphasizing vineyard expression and the distinctive character of Pritchard Hill.

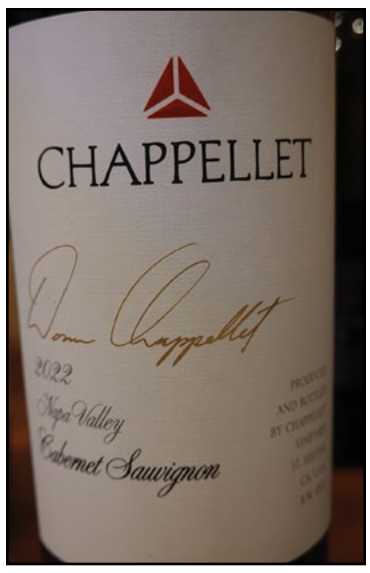
In an era when many Napa wineries have become corporate enterprises, Chappellet offers something increasingly rare: a family, a mountain and a clear sense of place. Its greatest achievement may be proving that Pritchard Hill was not merely a difficult place to grow grapes, but one of Napa Valley's extraordinary sources of Cabernet Sauvignon.

- **2025 Chappellet Chenin Blanc $75**

Chappellet has been producing Chenin Blanc long before it became the trendy hot grape in California. The wine shows a golden color with a faintly greenish hue. The palate sits at a medium to full-bodied weight, offering a plush yet mineral-driven core with peach and pear flavors. The fruit is tight and textured at this early stage. Juicy and mouthwatering, it finishes with a squeeze of fresh lemon, delivering freshness and drive.

- **2025 Chappellet Pinot Noir Apple Lane Vineyard $70**

Hailing from the Russian River Valley this inky dark Pinot is one of the biggest most powerful Pinots I have had in ages. Broad, silken and rich in the mouth it flows through a deep saturated and anise-tinged finish that lingers with firm, fine-grained tannins and a juicy core of intensely concentrated fruit flavors. The finish is long and satisfying. Very impressive.



Chappellet makes a classic style Cabernet Sauvignon.

- **2022 Chappellet Cabernet Sauvignon $95**

The wine opens with complex aromas of plums, blackberries, tobacco and currants. The oak is well-integrated. On the palate, the wine is full-bodied, richly tannic and very deep, with a layered, concentrated core of fruit framed by chalky tannins. The wine has great structure and should last for a couple of decades in the cellar.



The Chappellet Cabernet Franc was the top wine of the tasting.

- **2022 Chappellet Cabernet Franc $115**

Hints of tar, sage and black pepper accent cassis and black cherries in this medium-to-full-bodied effort. Rich and concentrated, it's supple, even creamy up front, then more velvety textured on the long, soft finish. Delicious but it will improve with time in the cellar.

- **2022 Chappellet Las Piedras $95**

This Bordeaux-style blend uses all five of the traditional Bordeaux grapes. It offers up aromas of dark berries, chocolate, plums, espresso and earth. It is medium-bodied deep and fleshy with a rich lively core of fruit, powdery tannins and a long, penetrating finish. The perfect partner to a grilled steak or lamb chops.



The Chappellet vineyard on Pritchard Hill

Chappellet Winery

1581 Sage Canyon Road, Saint Helena, CA

https://chappellet.com/

Tasting room is open Monday through Sunday from 10 am to 4 pm. To arrange your visit, please contact the Concierge team at

concierge@chappellet.com or (707) 286-4219.

Join
PIEDMONT SENIORS!

Piedmont Seniors sponsored by the
Piedmont Rec Department invites new members

Enjoy monthly speakers, local field trips,
camaraderie and making new friends

All Piedmont area seniors welcome!

Where: Piedmont Community Hall
711 Highland Ave

When: 4th Wednesday of each month
10:00 AM - 12:00 PM

Contact Janet Epstein, Coordinator:
jepstein@piedmont.ca.gov or
Piedmont Recreation Department: 510.420.3070

Weavers program connects Piedmont teens, seniors

By Jay Russell



Olivia Tran (left), Mary Carter, Dick Carter, and Elly Mak.

A new program called Weavers is getting Piedmont seniors and teens together for social visits aiming at intergenerational connectivity. The Piedmont chapter of Weavers was tested from April to June with more than 40 participants, thanks to the help of founding members and Piedmont students Allyson Huynh and Luca Laforte.

Gloria Lee of Oakland founded the program along with Kristin Richmond, the co-founder of Revolution Food. Lee, who lectures at Cal and Stanford, contacted Ken Li, the Crew Advisor of Piedmont Community Service Crew to get the program off the ground. She was then introduced to PHS juniors Huynh and Laforte, meeting in March to discuss the launch. Huynh started a Weavers' Instagram to recruit teenagers to participate and went door to door in Piedmont to find interested seniors.

Lee explained the origination of the program.

"My sons Corbin and Asher really benefited from their friendship with an older neighbor, who first invited them over to bake cookies when they were four and six years old," she said.

Richmond's son Caleb similarly started a window washing business and noticed that the older adults hiring him enjoyed chatting more than they cared about clean windows.

The Piedmont program in the spring started with six weekly visits between "Weavers," teens, and "Silvers" (seniors), and each visit lasted 60-90 minutes.

"We think it's really important that these relationships are mutually beneficial. We saw other well-meaning programs out there that treat one person in the relationship as someone who needs to be taken care of — but no one really wants to be the recipient of charity," said Lee.

Helping one another and building community is at the forefront of this work.

"While Weavers are able to lend a hand to Silvers with technology support, gardening, and light organizing. I have found that people really do enjoy just talking. It makes a difference in your day just to have a good long conversation with someone," said Huynh.

In the Spring pilot of Piedmont and Oakland region, there were 23 Weavers and 23 Silvers. Piedmont's Dick and Mary Carter signed up for the program because they like the concepts of intergeneration connection and people helping one another. They also joined because of the recommendation to join from longtime friend Ken Li.

"Just meeting and talking with these delightful, energetic young people is delightful," said Dick Carter. "I think older adults who don't have much contact and communications with teenagers would especially benefit and enjoy the program. However, everyone can benefit from having more contact with people who are different from them."

Carter also spoke of a reaffirmation that the future is in good hands after the meetings, a comment echoed by many of the Silvers participating.

"Intergenerational community to me feels like everyone, regardless of age, having positive relationships," said Huynh. "It feels like everyone coming together and being friends, making memories, and having fun. Having this kind of community is super important because really, everyone benefits."

"Weavers will have the opportunity not only to demonstrate their skills but also have those skills validated by an older adult with lots of life experience. One of the important things about this program is that both sides contribute and both sides benefit," said Lee.

All participants of the spring pilot signed up again for the fall sessions which begins this month.

Teenagers and seniors who want to learn about the program can visit beaweaver.com or call 510-788-0260.



Gael Pardi (left) and Asher Breeden.



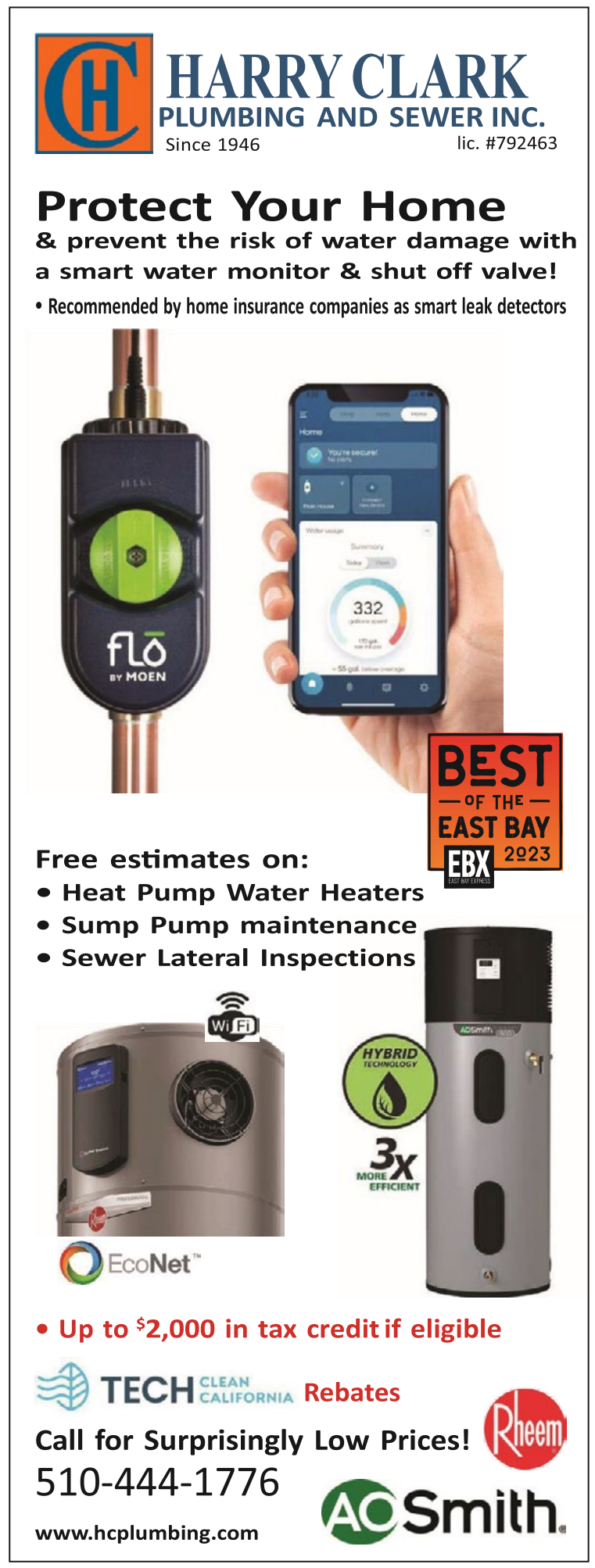
Nava Shaham (left) and Olivia Bailey.



Co-founder Kris Richmond leads a focus group with Silvers (seniors) in Mill Valley, the site of the program's second pilot.







Walking on Wednesday

The Ghirardelli house and other stories on Highland and Bonita

By Dick Carter

Last Wednesday the Piedmont Recreation Department's Walking on Wednesdays group drew 50 walkers and seven K-9 best friends to the Exedra for Part 2 of a walk they had enjoyed in early August.

Mary Carter was back to lead, again drawing on her former Wildwood School Piedmont history lessons and Ann Swift's 2007 *Cottages and Castles – The Centennial Houses of the City of Piedmont* for a second visit to historical, pre-1906 San Francisco Earthquake Piedmont homes. Swift's book describes 173 of the city's historic homes that qualified in 2007 as Piedmont Centennial Homes. August's walk covered mostly Hillside Avenue; this one turned to Highland and Bonita.

Mary started up Highland at 636, commonly known as "The Ghirardelli House," one of the more noteworthy and beautiful homes in central Piedmont. George and Grace Howell built a Mission Style home there before 1903, then hired A.W. Smith to build a larger Tudor next door at 630 Highland on a lot they owned. In 1905 they sold 636 to Joseph and Ellen (Ellie) Ghirardelli, the son and daughter-in-law of Domenico Ghirardelli, the Italian-trained chocolatier who emigrated from Genoa to Uruguay in 1838, came north for the Gold Rush, and founded his chocolate company where Ghirardelli Square stands today.

Joseph, born in 1852, was the third of the Ghirardellis' eight children. He worked in the family business and was in Santa Cruz when the 1906 earthquake struck. With no transportation available back to the East Bay, he set out on foot and died of a heart attack on the way. He never lived in the Highland Avenue house, which was then being remodeled from Mission Style to the Colonial Revival we see today. Ellie and their two daughters moved in once the work was finished.

Back up Highland, the group passed 1900 Oakland Avenue — "The Rackliffe House," built in 1899 with captivating witch's cap turrets — and, across the street, the turreted Queen Anne at 225 Highland. John and Annie Hendry sold lots there to Maggie Perry in 1897; she built the house in 1898 and rented to the Hendrys, who eventually bought it from her. A 1910 proposal to line the street with retail stores set off a battle among the neighbors, and the widening that followed in 1911 claimed Annie's front garden. She had the house put on rollers and moved with a significant setback so that her garden would never again be violated.

At Highland's corner with Moraga Avenue stands 7 Highland, built in 1907 by Frank C. Havens' Piedmont Development Company to showcase homes and sell lots in Piedmont. Current homeowner Patty Edmonds came out to tell the walkers her family's history with it: her mother and stepfather lived there 55 years until their passings, and Patty and her husband, Art, moved in later. She said the couple recently noticed a bulge around the front entrance and discovered the wire support for the stucco exterior had fully deteriorated after 120 years. It has been replaced, and the exterior will be painted soon to complete the project.

Down Moraga and up Bonita, the walkers noted 24 Bonita, built in 1904 with deep eaves and brown shingles, and 42 Bonita, built in 1905 — a "hybrid house," Mary said, originally wood-sided Colonial Revival until brown shingles added sometime after 1926 gave it a Craftsman look. Its owner, spotting half a hundred visitors outside, came out to see what was going on; the words "Wednesday Walkers" explained everything. He provided a little more information about the home but declined to be identified for this report.

Farther along, 112 Bonita is a "twin house" to a Hillside home built in 1905. The Queen Anne "Berkenfeld House" at 227 Bonita has rooftop gargoyles, spindle work posts, corbels, and window panels. Its initial owner was one of the original Piedmont volunteer firefighters, who helped save a house at 116 Hillside — and possibly the block — during

See Wednesday Walkers on page 27



Mary Carter talking to the walkers



Patty Edmonds and Mary Carter in front of Patty's Home.



Among those participating were Moya Robinson with K-9 best friend Petunia, Albert Chen, Bill Ahern, Juliane Jacqueline, Kristin Howard, Audrey Sung, Matt Truesdell, Ken Moy, Alissa Quan, Nancy DeRoche with K-9 best friend Pepper, Rich Harms, Matt Gerhardt, Judy Love, Debbie Powell, Jack Fischrup with K-9 best friend Kojak, Cathy Laymon, Peggy Shultz, Noemi Alvarado, Vicki Trimbach, Pat Nicholas, Jim Kuo, Brian Hamlin, Denny McGee, Mary Ann Barnes, Greg Keller, Claudine Bach, Caskey Weston, Melba Yee, Chuck Oraftik, Rick Eigenbrode, Marion Lim Yankowitz, Mark Davis, Sherry Jacobs, Mary Carter, Charlene Louie, Mary Henderson, Alan Jolly, Sanghi Wagner, Dan Sedonis, Deborah Curtin with K-9 best friend Brie, Pat Keller, Bern Schild, Karin Fetherston with K-9 best friend Gwen, and Dick Carter. The group was pleased to have Christine Cumbelich with K-9 best friend Kobe, Anne Gritzer, Iris Chavarria, Al Chen with K-9 best friend Sherlock, and Eli Messinger walking with them for the first time.

25 Indie Next Best Reads of September

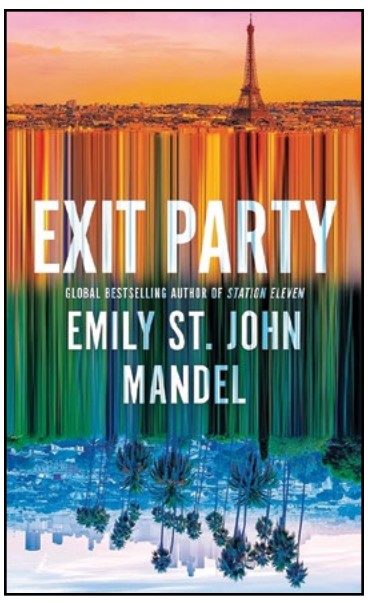
September's iteration of the Indie Next List features new tantalizing romance reads and a robust variety of genres including gothic and a graphic novel.

Checking out the Indie Next List is a good start towards finding the newest contemporary reads. The titles below received rave reviews from independent bookstore owners from across the country.

The American Booksellers Association fights to keep independently owned bookstores alive and thriving and supporting their local communities with brick and mortar locales to buy books and give patronage to literature. At the start of each month ABA publishes a list of inspired recommendations by picking 25 new releases called the "Indie Next List."

Go to Indiebound.org/indie-next-list for archives of recommendations, more information and ways to order that will support the small book store culture.

September's #1 Pick



***Exit Party* by Emily St. John Mandel starts off in the year 2031 as the Republic of California declares its independence.**

Exit Party
By Emily St. John Mandel, Knopf, Fiction

"A world descending into chaos. Another strangled by repression and surveillance. Imperfect choices… which do you fear more? More importantly, Emily St. John Mandel asks: which world will be ours?"

—Anmiryam Budner, Main Point Books, Wayne, PA

Grim Tidings (Ghosted #2)
By B.K. Borison, Avon, Paperback, Sept. 15, Romance

"B.K. Borison writes about love as if it's magic, and of course, *Grim Tidings* is steeped in both. Enemies to lovers with so much yearning and angst and sass, immortals with gooey insides and hard shells cracked open by one another."

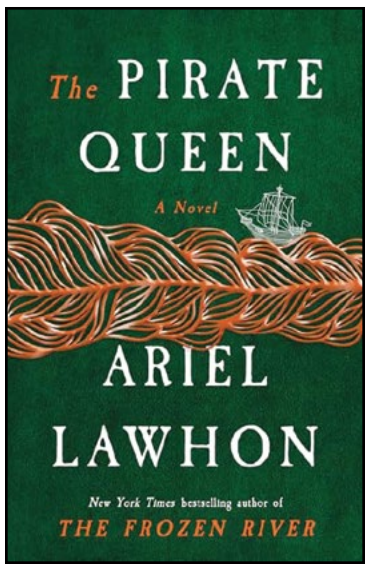
—Becca Miner, Sidetrack Bookshop, Royal Oak, MI

Under Story
By Chloe Benjamin, G.P. Putnam's Sons, Fiction

"I love the way Chloe Benjamin writes about time — the urgency of this moment, the movement towards something, and the obligation to get it right or try again. This will be one of my favorite books of the year."

—Daniel Graham, Book Soup, West Hollywood, CA

The Pirate Queen
By Ariel Lawhon, Doubleday, Historical Fiction



"A fierce tale about Grace O'Malley — a pirate, leader of armies, and defender of her people during the reign of Elizabeth I. I was enthralled by the structure of this narrative and by this incredible woman that history almost erased."

—Carrie Deming, The Dog Eared Book, Palmyra, NY

The Oxford Guide to Scandal and Lies
By Kate Westbury, Minotaur Books, Mystery

"Post-WWII Oxford has never been this fun to get lost in. Give me a reluctant partnership and a slow burn any day. The thrill of discovery and uncovering kept driving this forward and the romance was the cherry on top."

—Mackenzie Cooper, Ballast Book Company, Bremerton, WA

Taipei Story (Deluxe Limited Edition)
By R. F. Kuang, William Morrow, Fiction

"This collection of vignettes from a language study summer program in Taipei captures feelings of diaspora, inadequacy, grief, vulnerability, connection, and growth. It's a tender and bittersweet exploration of how cultures shape you."

—Sydney Mancini, Content Bookstore, Northfield, MN

Daggerbound (Swordheart #2)
By T. Kingfisher, Bramble, Fantasy

"What an absolute delight of a fantasy adventure! Kingfisher has a way of capturing what it feels like to play Dungeons and Dragons with your friends, but in novel form. The perfect balance of humor, romance, and edge of your seat action."

—Emma Lucore, East City Bookshop, Washington, DC

The Witches of Cambridge
By Alice Hoffman, Scribner, Fiction

"A delightful return to New England witchy magic with plenty of callbacks to actual history and practices that will resonate with readers. Hoffman is a master of cozy found family sisterhood."

—Sara Crow, Crow & Co. Books, Hutchinson, KS

Tempest (Deluxe Limited Edition)
By Victoria Aveyard, Harper Voyager, Fantasy

"This pirate adventure book is equally adventurous as it is romantic. Cat is cunning, deceptive, strong, and most importantly, alive, and she intends to stay that way, regardless of who she might have to reconnect with or betray to do so."

—Catherine Chapman, Lovestruck in Seattle, Seattle, WA

The Birthing Tree
By Amanda Peters, Catapult, Fiction

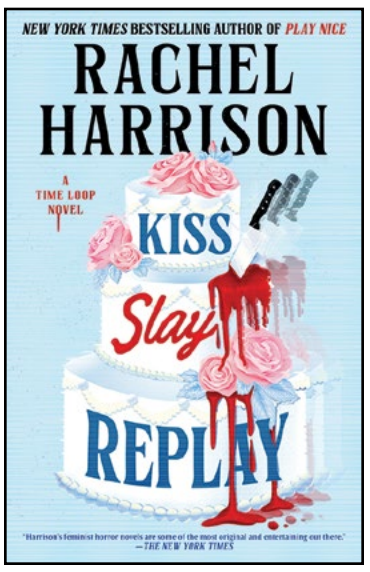
"The beating heart of this novel is the beautiful yet fragile act of giving birth. Decades of Mi'kmaq tradition fade then resurface within its pages. Amanda Peters perfectly weaves the connections of nature, family, & community, and remains the best kind of storyteller."

—Liz Laconis, Blue Willow Bookshop, Houston, TX

The Disappearers
By Marlon James, Riverhead Books, Fiction

"A detailed, alive, intense novel that gazes unflinchingly at the violence — physical, emotional, and existential — that generations of gay men have endured in Jamaica and beyond. These characters have a space in my heart forever."

—Maris Fessenden, Country Bookshelf, Bozeman, MT



Kiss Slay Replay
By Rachel Harrison, Berkley, Horror

"*Kiss Slay Replay* makes the time-loop wedding weekend feel fresh by grounding every bloody turn in friendship, regret, and the lives we keep pretending we still want. I tore through it and immediately wanted to start over."

—Stephanie Rose, Death by TBR Books, Bremerton, WA

Hollow Bones
By Jodi Picoult, Ballantine Books, Fiction

"Picoult once again touches on deep, complicated and timely issues from multiple points of view. Tragedy, pain, forgiveness, hope and love carry the book along at an unputdownable pace. I loved this book!"

—Nadine Melahn, CoffeeTree Books, Morehead, KY

See You Next Tuesday
By Kate Stayman-London, Dial Press Trade Paperback, Romance

"Like the author, I worked on Democratic campaigns. This book transported me back to my campaign days of late nights, endless pizza and emotions running high. Anya and Gabe reminded me so much of my campaign crush back in 2016, and I couldn't help but think about what could have happened between us. I loved everything about this book."

—Sam Miller, The Novel Notion, Athens, OH

Crocodilopolis
By John Manuel Arias, Bloomsbury Publishing, Fiction

"A rich, fiery modern retelling of Cain and Abel with all the lush greens of Costa Rica. As a spider spins a web to catch his prey, Seth conspires to trap his brother Osario in the death roll of a crocodile; the ripples in the water reflecting their lineage of envy and corruption."

—Sarah Valencia, Politics and Prose Bookstore, Washington, DC



Switzy
By Emma Cline, Random House, Fiction

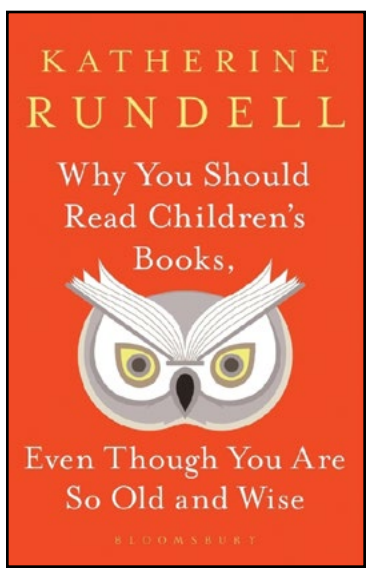
"Much has been written about dementia and Alzheimer's from the outsider's perspective. But to write the experience from the inside, from the point of view of memory itself, is truly remarkable. This is a book of overwhelming insight, compassion, and ingenuity."

—Kristen Iskandrian, Thank You Books, Birmingham, AL

Ship Happens
By Mason Deaver, Avon, Romance

"I'm not exaggerating when I say that this book has everything I've wanted in any piece of media ever. Transgender AND disability rep, and a diverse found family of characters that makes your stomach hurt from laughter and your heart ache all at once? Heaven."

—Joey Santo Domingo, Black Garnet Books, Saint Paul, MN



Why You Should Read Children's Books, Even Though You Are So Old and Wise
By Katherine Rundell, Knopf Books for Young Readers, Essays

"A fun little book focused on the joys and wonders of children's books. Recommended for those who think they are too old to read kids' books and for readers who adore them."

—Lauren Brown, The Story Shop, Monroe, GA

A Study in Sparkling
By Jodi McAlister, Atria Books, Romance

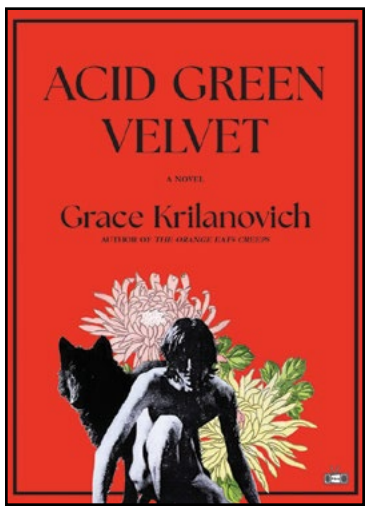
"I loved the continuation of this universe through Fiona and Satoshi's story! The struggle and the stressors of their lives, coupled with differing life stages and ages make for a tension-filled story of yearning. It was a book I couldn't put down!"

—Tess Starman, Shelf Love DSM, Des Moines, IA

She's a Doll
By Barbara Truelove, Bindery Books, Horror

"This is not your usual haunted doll story. Violent, devastating, and surprisingly serious as well as hilarious. When Lucy is killed unexpectedly, she possesses one of her grandmother's dolls and is determined to get revenge on her killer. Preferably by killing him."

—Clara Gauthier, Courageous Books, Dexter, MI



Acid Green Velvet
By Grace Krilanovich, Two Dollar Radio, Gothic

"Acid Green Velvet is the hallucinogenic hard stuff; I'll be feeling the effects of its vertiginous language, its scary truths about power and money, and its portrayal of a deranged (yet still moral) world for a long time."

—Benjamin Rybeck, House of Books, Kent, CT

Books, Iced Coffee & a Side of Dragons: A Graphic Novel
By Amanda Lovelace, Raquel Travé (Illus.), Andrews McMeel Publishing, Romance, Fantasy

"This was the sweetest graphic novel ever. As a fat, sapphic bookseller myself, the ending made me tear up. Sweet, realistic but fantastical, and the cutest love stories spread as diversely as they are in real life."

—Caitlyn Vanorder, Bookmarks, Winston-Salem, NC

Saving Noah (Deluxe Edition)
By Lucinda Berry, Poisoned Pen Press, Fiction

"This is one of the best books I have ever read. It is dark and heavy, and it does not shy away from uncomfortable themes. It pushes you to examine beliefs, assumptions, and morality in a way no book has done before or since for me. (Be sure to check the trigger warnings before you pick it up as the topics are HEAVY.)"

—Candace Lynn, Sower Books, Lincoln, NE

The Rise and Fall of the Artificial State
By Jill Lepore, Liveright, Political Science

"Lepore does a masterful job laying out how we got to this point with AI and the role a small number of tech billionaires play in our lives. Their inspirations are frightening and something everyone should know. What we do with that knowledge is up to us!"

—Amber Taylor, Fonts Books, McLean, VA

The Poison Daughter
By Sheila Masterson, Slowburn, Romance

"Standalone fantasy is so hard to come by but this one checked all the boxes! Harlow is a woman full of poison who meets her worst nightmare: a man she cannot kill. I breezed through these 600+ pages!"

—Elizabeth Gorby, Charter Books, Newport, RI

Obituaries

Remembering Gary Laymon: Creating Beauty, Sharing Joy

Gary Laymon, 68, of Piedmont, California, passed away peacefully on July 24, 2026 after a nearly two-year journey with cancer. He was a cherished husband, father, son, brother, neighbor, colleague, and friend and he will be deeply missed.

Gary was born in 1958 to Rose and Maurice Laymon in Indianapolis, Indiana. They moved to the Bay Area, where his younger sister, Nancy, was born in 1961. The young family lived between Mount Tamalpais and Mount Diablo, eventually settling in Danville. The Laymons were involved in their local church, and Gary loved going to the youth group. He also enjoyed singing in the church choir, bowling, playing golf, and doing yard work when he wasn't pulling goofy pranks with his friends. He graduated from Monte Vista High School in 1976, and began pursuing a degree in Landscape Architecture at Cal Poly in San Luis Obispo that fall. After graduating, Gary landed a job with Guzzardo & Associates, a landscape architecture firm in San Francisco, where he would spend the next 46 years.

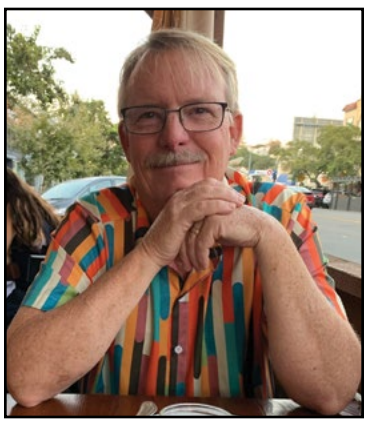
He began attending First Presbyterian Church of Berkeley in the '80s, meeting many dear friends and was involved in several fellowship groups. Through a young adult group, he met Cathy Ives, who invited him to a party marking the anniversary of the 1989 Loma Prieta earthquake. His world was rocked as through some blessed misread signals each believed the other to be flirting, and suddenly Gary saw his friend in a new light. They were together ever since the "Great Misunderstanding," marrying October 3rd, 1992, and welcoming Emily in 1996, Claire in 1999, and Elissa in 2002.

Gary was a devoted father, known for his silliness, humor, and sense of adventure. He shared with his daughters his love of the ocean, music, gardens, art, bike riding, and travel creating countless memories along the way.

As a young family, the Laymons enjoyed bike rides in wine country, hikes in the East Bay Hills, annual trips to Half Moon Bay's pumpkin patches, Disneyland trips, summer musicals at Woodminster theaters, sports games, innumerable dance recitals, and summers with extended family at Mount Hermon, where Gary had gone as a child. As the girls grew older, the family traveled together to France, Spain, and Italy, went wine tasting and bike riding, toured an excessive number of gardens and art museums, and took thousands upon thousands of photos.

In 2000, Gary became partner and owner at The Guzzardo Partnership with his long-term colleague Paul Lettieri. Gary was passionate about landscape design and loved working with clients to bring projects to life. He also enjoyed mentoring and teaching colleagues who were newer to the profession. Any drive in the car with Gary inevitably included him pointing out the many, many projects he had worked on over the years.

In his free time, Gary painted with acrylics, moving through phases of vineyards, palm trees, scenes from his travels, surfboards and abstract pieces inspired by his favorite jazz compositions. He loved sharing his art, displaying it at church and participating in the Piedmont Art Walk over several years.



Piedmont resident Gary Laymon died on July 24, 2026, at age 68.

Gary's faith was integral to his life. He started the day with Bible study and prayer. He saw needs and felt led to help. He was known for being kind, humble, gentle, grateful and generous. He was involved in several projects at church and led work groups at CityTeam Oakland, an organization near and dear to his heart.

Mostly, Gary loved the routine of the life he loved: commuting to work in SF by bike and ferry, church on Sunday with Cathy by his side and being the last to leave the sanctuary, never having chatted with quite enough people; drinking Peet's coffee every morning from a cup he painted when the kids were young at Color Me Mine; creating immersive scenes from scripture in his garage-turned-studio space with his paint brush; marveling at the miracle of streaming music on Spotify; calling out "sunset alert!" in the house when the view was too stunning to miss; working hard in the yard, always wanting to make things more beautiful.

It was never enough to marvel at something alone. Gary wanted to share his awe, share his vision, and share the beautiful things he created to the fullest extent possible.

Gary is survived by his wife, Cathy Laymon of Piedmont; his daughters, Emily West (Nick) of San Diego, Claire Laymon of Piedmont, Elissa Laymon of San Francisco; his mother, Rose Laymon, of Walnut Creek, and his sister, Nancy Laymon, of Chico. He was preceded in death by his father, Maurice Laymon.

In lieu of flowers, the family requests that donations be made in Gary's memory to CityTeam Oakland.



Gary with his paintings at the Piedmont Art Walk



Gary with his family (from l to r) Nick, Emily, Cathy, Gary, Claire, Elissa

In Loving Memory

Abigail (Abby) Wheeler

2001 – 2026



Abby graduated in 2020 from Piedmont High School and in 2025 from the University of Glasgow with a major in sociology. Abby was living and working in Scotland. She died July 26, 2026 in a scuba diving accident. Abby loved the ocean and its sea life. She also loved her friends, geocaching, music, travel and reading books. She had a great sense of humor and a joy for living.

Abby is and will be sorely missed by her parents Faye Beverett and Charlie Wheeler. She is survived by uncles, aunts-in-law and cousins.

If you wish to honor Abby's memory, please consider a donation to a Scottish marine sanctuary: Seawilding: https://www.seawilding.org/, or COAST – Community of Arran Seabed Trust https://www.arrancoast.com/about/.

James Richard Saunders, Jr., MD



James Richard Saunders passed away peacefully on July 11, 2026. He was 82 years old.

James Richard Saunders, Jr., known as Jim to family and friends and "Pops" to his grandchildren, passed away peacefully at his home in Piedmont, California on July 11, 2026, surrounded by family. He was 82 years old.

Jim was born on August 5, 1943, in Omaha, Nebraska. He grew up in Menlo Park, California, where he attended Menlo-Atherton High School. He went on to graduate from Johns Hopkins University before earning his medical degree from the University of California, San Francisco School of Medicine.

While at Menlo-Atherton, Jim met Lynn, who would become his wife and lifelong partner. They were married for 59 years and built a life together while raising their three children and, in later years, enjoying the company of their six grandchildren, all of whom live within a mile.

Jim practiced internal medicine for more than 40 years, spending the majority of his career with Oakland Medical Group. He took great pride in the lasting relationships he built with his patients, many of whom remained with him throughout his career. Medicine was more than a profession to Jim; it was a passion he cared deeply about and approached with dedication, compassion, and integrity.

Outside of medicine, Jim had a lifelong love of the outdoors and stayed active through running, cycling, and hiking. He was a devoted Oakland sports fan and always knew the latest scores. Whether following the A's, Raiders, or Warriors, he enjoyed keeping up with his teams through every season. Jim was also well known for his quick wit and sense of humor.

Jim is survived by his devoted wife, Lynn; his son, Vince Saunders and his wife, Michelle, and their children, Henry and Charlie; his son, Jamie Saunders and his wife, Teebie, and their children, George and Jane; and his daughter, Ashley Stevanovic and her husband, Andreja, and their children, Luka and Nicholas.

He was preceded in death by his parents, James and Marion Saunders, and his sister, Joanne.

Jim will be remembered as a dedicated physician, a loyal friend, and a devoted husband, father, and grandfather. His family will miss his humor, his steady presence, and the many ways he quietly showed his love over the years.

In lieu of flowers, the family kindly requests that donations be made to the charity of your choice in Jim's memory.



Boys' Water Polo

Continued from page 10

games is foreign to the water polo program, despite it being NCS champions in 2023 and a top-four postseason seed every year since 2021. Patty wants the PHS student body to know that they are extremely excited to host them, and wants the Purple Pit to show up.

"Having a crowd makes me improve my game and it makes us come together as a team. I want my classmates out here," Patty said.

Piedmont also went 2-1 at the Labor Day Tournament hosted by Newark Memorial on Friday and Saturday, September 4-5; beating Bishop O'Dowd 15-11 and Mission San Jose 13-5, but losing 10-9 to league rival Berkeley.

8-7 loss to James Logan

Piedmont's Wilson Walker got PHS an early lead at the 5:10 mark of the first quarter, but James Logan stormed ahead with three unanswered to lead 3-1 through the opening seven minutes. The Colts maintained the two goal advantage to lead 5-3 through the second, including Patty assisting Wilson for a goal and Patty scoring via a 5-meter penalty.

In the third, PHS tied the match at 5-5 with two minutes left. Wilson assisted Patty for a goal with 3:21 left before Henry Stein scored with two minutes left. However, JLHS scored 30 seconds later to take a 6-5 lead into the fourth.

Patty drew a 5-meter penalty early in the fourth, leading to Stein scoring with 5:23 left. Patty then gave PHS a 7-6 lead with 1:52 left in the fourth. But with 16 seconds left, James Logan scored the equalizer to force overtime.

Both teams went scoreless through the first period, including Wilson hitting the crossbar with a minute left. Graham Smith had a shot saved nine seconds into the second period of overtime. But with 35 seconds left, James Logan scored the winner. PHS had one last possession, resulting in Stein having a shot smack off the crossbar with 12 seconds left.

Final stats: Wilson had two goals and one assist. Stein had two goals. Patty had three goals and one assist. Goalie Dylan Jerez had nine saves.

15-11 over Bishop O'Dowd

The game was tied 4-4 through the first quarter, but PHS took a 9-6 lead with a strong second quarter. BOD cut the deficit to 11-9 in the third, but PHS added four more goals while conceding two in the final going.

Final stats: Stein had six goals, two assists, and four steals. Patty had five goals, one assist and a steal. Wilson had one goal and assist. Travers Kemp had one goal. Raff Banin had one assist and steal. Graham Smith had an assist. Jerez had 10 saves, one steal, and five assists.

13-5 over Mission San Jose

Piedmont led 3-0 through the first quarter and 5-2 by halftime. They scored six goals in the third while conceding one, and another two goals in the fourth while allowing two.

Final stats: Patty had five goals and two assists. Stein had three goals, two assists, and a steal. Wilson had two goals and three steals. Jack Dahling and Amen had individual goals.

10-9 loss to Berkeley

Piedmont led 3-2 through the first quarter, while Berkeley tied it 5-5 going into halftime. The Highlanders took an 8-7 lead in the third, but the Yellowjackets out-scored PHS 3-2 in the final quarter to win 10-9.

Final stats: Stein had four goals, one assist, and four steals. Patty had three goals, one assist. Banin had one goal and two assists. Smith had one goal, while Wilson had an assist. Jerez had four saves, one steal, and one assist.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (4-3 overall) hosts Clayton Valley Charter today, September 9, at 4:30 p.m.



Henry Stein scored a 5-meter penalty against James Logan.

Cross Country

Continued from page 11

With a first meet of the season, Zirkelbach mentioned that the team is still transitioning from preseason training to regular season racing.

"We really haven't spent much time teaching race strategy yet, and most of our experienced runners were training through this meet without any significant reduction in their workload. So this was exactly what we needed: a chance to compete, establish an early-season benchmark, and identify some things we can get better at. One of the things we're going to work on now is how to distribute effort through an entire cross country race," Zirkelbach said.

NEXT UP

Piedmont will compete at the Ed Sias Invitational in Hidden Valley Park in Martinez on Saturday, September 12 at 8:30 a.m.

Football

Continued from page 10

Piedmont scored on its ensuing possession with a 14-play, 88 yard series to give them a 7-0 lead with 5:22 remaining in the first half. It featured carries of 16 and 15 yards by Mumtaz before capping off with a 24-yard touchdown on a short pass from Jonah Cha-Foster where the running back broke multiple tackles on his way to the end zone. Although PHS didn't score in the remaining time of the second quarter, they had a 29-yard touchdown run by Mumtaz called back because of a penalty.

In the third, both teams traded possession before PHS' next touchdown. They scored with 6:14 left when Cha-Foster found Diego Hurwitz for a 16-yard touchdown to finish a 49-yard series in six plays – making it 14-0 after another converted extra point by Cyrus Emanuelson.

PHS' next score came with 11:37 left in the fourth quarter on their first play of a new series. On 1st-and-10 at the St. Mary's 35, Emanuelson passed to Mumtaz on a short-route, leading to the running back switching the field on a touchdown sprint through the defense.

The Highlanders' final goal came with 4:00 left in the game. This time, Emanuelson hit Hurwitz on an 11-yard slant to the goal line.

Final stats: Cha-Foster completed eight passes for 94 yards and two touchdowns, to go along with 13 rushing yards. Emanuelson completed four passes for 52 yards and two touchdowns. Mumtaz had 130 rushing yards on 12 carries, and three receptions for 50 yards and two touchdowns. Hurwitz had three receptions for 28 yards and two touchdowns. Mason Gray had four receptions for 35 yards and one tackle for loss. John Bunje had one tackle for loss, Gus Leonard had one sack, Max Fujimoto had one tackle for loss. Curran had an interception. Kayode Zuberi had one pass defense, 1.5 sacks. Aiden Shartsis had 2.5 sacks. Hong had a tackle for loss.



Aiden Shartsis recording one of Piedmont's five sacks. He had 2.5 sacks on the night.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (1-1 overall) hosts Salesian on Friday, September 11 at 7:00 p.m.

Loud & Close

Continued from page 16

Hanks), a call from the 105th floor of one of the towers where he has been attending a meeting. Something has happened, but he is just fine and everyone has been told to remain in place. Message two has an edge of uncertainty to it, yet remains reassuring. There are six calls in all, each seeming more fraught than the previous one, until the last message ("hello…are you there? Are you there?") abruptly stops, followed by a long moment of silence.

Oskar, who has turned on the television, watches in disbelief as the towers fall, as if in slow motion, each vanishing into billowing clouds of dust. Horrified, he runs to his room and crawls under his bed, waiting for his mother, Linda (Sandra Bullock), to return from work. Finally she arrives, and knowing what has occurred coaxes him out and into her arms.

Oskar is incapable of accepting the loss of his father, his grief immeasurable, and when his mother has an empty-casket funeral, he refuses to attend, observing the ceremony from a distance, his denial palpable.

And so a year passes, and finally, reluctantly, Oskar enters his father's den and begins to look through his things. And when taking down a box, he knocks a blue vase off the shelf, breaking it. Among the fragments he discovers a small envelope with the name "Black" written on it. Inside he finds an unusual, corrugated key. Oskar holds the key in his hand, and it is in that moment that he becomes convinced that the key fits a lock, a box perhaps, that contains a message from his father.

And thus we learn, through flashbacks, that over the years Thomas has created what he called "reconnaissance expeditions," a scavenger hunt of sorts, which sends Oskar out into the streets of New York in search of what they call "the sixth borough."

And so attaching the key to a lanyard, which he wears around his neck, Oskar is inspired to begin a similar expedition. He starts by looking through a massive NYC phone book, and finds that there are 472 Blacks listed. His mission, kept a secret from his mother, is to visit all of them, asking if they recognize the key.

His first stop is at the home of Abby Black (Viola Davis), and it's during his conversation with her that he mentions he has been tested for Asperger's Syndrome with inconclusive results. We know that Oskar is precocious, at times brusque, highly verbal, but we soon learn that Thomas' expeditions were about much more than simply a sixth borough hunt, but a way of sending his son into a world in which he is inherently uncomfortable. Abby has no idea about the key, and so Oskar continues, from Black to Black, showing each of them the key, and using his father's vintage camera takes their photograph, which he keeps in a notebook.

To refer to *Extremely Loud & Incredibly Close* as a work of art may verge on hyperbole. And yet, doesn't it represent the use of images and narrative as only film can, to explore the depths of grief and loss while focusing on the emotions of a young boy who struggles to find meaning in what he angrily judges is meaningless. The key becomes a metaphor for Oskar's arduous and at times fraught search for answers to questions that are timeless: to what purpose? To what end? And, ultimately, why?

Extremely Loud & Incredibly Close. *Directed by Stephen Daldry. Starring Thomas Horn, Tom Hanks, Sandra Bullock, Max von Sydow. 2 hrs, 9 min. Rated PG-13. Released in 2011. Streaming on Roku/Prime/Fandango/Apple.*

SUDOKU SOLUTION

8	1	4	6	7	2	9	5	3
9	7	3	5	8	1	6	2	4
6	5	2	3	4	9	1	7	8
7	4	1	2	9	8	5	3	6
3	8	9	7	6	5	4	1	2
5	2	6	1	3	4	7	8	9
4	3	5	8	1	6	2	9	7
2	9	7	4	5	3	8	6	1
1	6	8	9	2	7	3	4	5

CROSSWORD SOLUTION

1 E	2 R	3 G	4 O	■	5 A	6 D	7 D	8 S	■	9 A	10 C	11 T	12 U	13 P
14 W	A	R	M	■	15 B	A	I	O	■	16 G	E	S	S	O
17 E	V	E	N	■	18 S	U	S	S	■	19 A	D	A	M	S
20 R	E	G	I	21 M	E	N	T	A	22 L	M	A	R	C	H
■	■	■	■	23 A	N	T	I	■	24 O	A	R	■	■	■
25 D	26 I	27 G	28 E	S	T	■	29 L	30 E	G	S	■	31 N	32 A	33 T
34 E	N	U	R	E	■	35 A	L	T	I	■	36 D	O	D	O
37 M	A	Y	O	R	38 A	L	■	39 O	C	40 T	O	B	E	R
41 O	W	E	S	■	42 L	I	43 O	N	■	44 H	E	L	P	S
45 B	E	D	■	46 S	T	A	N	■	47 R	I	S	E	T	O
■	■	■	48 S	C	H	■	49 E	50 C	O	N	■	■	■	■
51 F	52 I	53 F	T	H	O	54 F	N	O	V	E	55 M	56 B	57 E	58 R
59 I	N	U	R	E	■	60 A	O	N	E	■	61 G	R	A	Y
62 S	C	R	U	M	■	63 S	T	A	R	■	64 M	I	R	E
65 H	A	S	T	E	■	66 B	E	N	S	■	67 T	E	S	S

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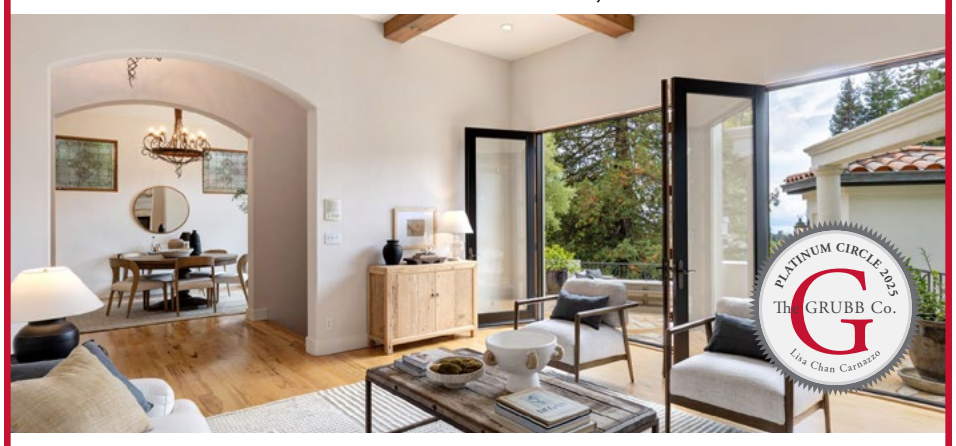
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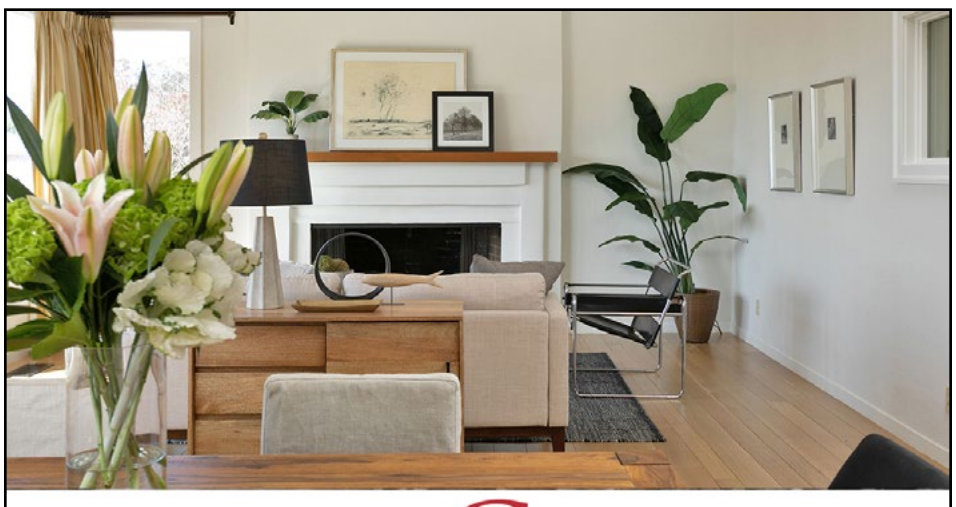
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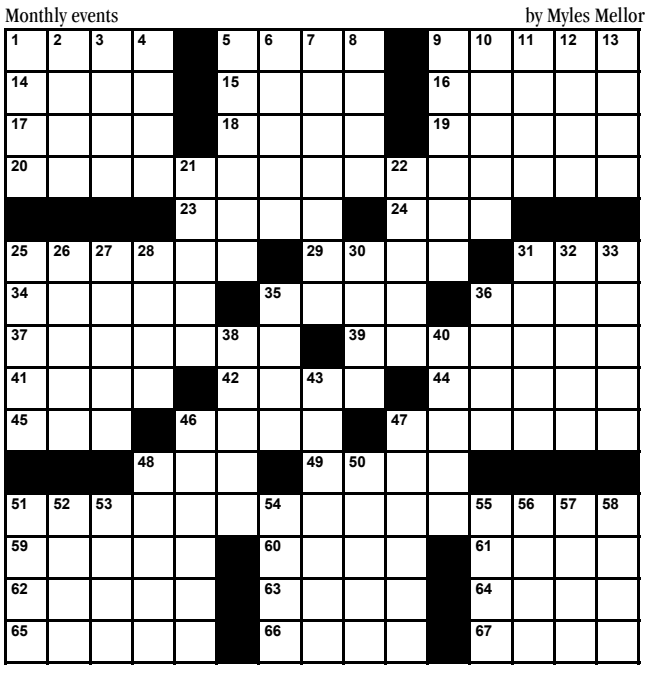
Sudoku Puzzle

Sudoku by Myles Mellor

	1				2		5	
9		3			1			
				4			7	8
		1		9			3	
	8			6			1	2
		6			4	7		
4						2		7
					3			
				2			4	

Crossword Puzzle

Monthly events by Myles Mellor



ACROSS
1. So
5. Computes the bottom line
9. Carry on
14. Cordial
15. TV actor, Scott
16. Painter's plaster
17. Fifty-fifty
18. Figure (out)
19. Bond girl in "Octopussy"
20. Army parade
23. Biotic preceder
24. Propel, in a way
25. Compendium
29. Parts of journeys
31. A Turner
34. Get used (to)
35. Countertenors
36. Dummy
37. Relating to a city leader
39. Fest beginning
41. Has a tab
42. Barry Sanders, once
44. Assists
45. Four-poster, e.g.
46. Getz, jazz tenor
47. Meet, as expectations
48. P.T.A. meeting place, abbr.
49. Supply-and-demand subj.
51. When President Eisenhower was elected and George Foreman became the oldest heavyweight boxing champion of the world
59. Acclimate
60. Blue-ribbon
61. Like many a winter sky
62. Rugby formation
63. Betelgeuse, for one
64. Marsh
65. Undue speed
66. Actors Kingsley and Affleck
67. Hardy role

DOWN
1. Bedside pitcher
2. Five-star review
3. Norman with a legendary swing
4. It means everything
5. Out
6. Intimidate
7. Purify liquid
8. Cubs big hitter
9. Long-tailed lizards
10. Moth repellent
11. Supreme ruler, long gone
12. Letters at Camp Lejeune
13. Sumptuous
21. Electromagnetic amplifier
22. Deductive reasoning
25. Disband troops
26. Wide-eyed
27. Steadied with a rope
28. A god of love
30. School for English princes
31. Majestic
32. Handy
33. Sculptor's work
35. Inter ___
36. Fawns' moms
38. Despite, abbr.
40. Yours in the Bible
43. Microsoft program
46. Intrigue
47. Wandering ones
48. Swagger
50. Sir Arthur ___ Doyle
51. Trawler's haul
52. Machu Picchu builder
53. Animal activist's aversions
54. GAAP policy setters
55. People in charge, abbr.
56. Cheese on crackers
57. Wet behind the ___
58. Bread types

See Crossword and Sudoku Puzzle Solutions on page 23.

Candidates Q&A

Continued from page 1

highest household income in Alameda County, yet few residents know our city government operates on less per capita than Berkeley, Oakland, and Emeryville. Without a significant commercial tax base, Piedmont has fewer levers to increase revenue and therefore must be extra-vigilant with how it manages expenses.

Community engagement sounds like a "nice to have" and not a "need to have." However, I believe the solutions to the challenges we face as a city depend on the "connective tissue" of citizenship that these programs help create.

Three questions I'll ask on every issue:

Does it promote safety?

Can we afford it?

Will it bring people together?



Nancy Beninati
(nancyforpiedmont.com)

After listening to residents throughout Piedmont, I have heard a clear desire to protect what makes our community special while planning responsibly for our future. The community's priorities are my priorities.

Public Safety: Ensuring safe roads, robust emergency preparedness, and strong police and fire services so our neighborhoods are safe and prepared.

Good Governance: Managing our resources wisely and ensuring residents have a meaningful voice in local decisions through fiscal responsibility, transparency, and genuine engagement.

Preserving Community and Sustainability: Responsibly meeting state housing mandates and future community needs while ensuring Piedmont remains a true home, not just a city. This requires investing thoughtfully in our infrastructure and planning for long-term environmental and financial sustainability.

If elected, my priority will be to bring a resident-first approach to City Hall from day one. I will ensure our community's everyday concerns directly shape upcoming decisions on housing, safety, and budget. My goal is to be a collaborative, accessible leader who works alongside my colleagues to make thoughtful, neighborly choices for Piedmont.



Adam Hundt

First, our community's old homes are expensive to live in due to energy inefficiency. Although the median home value has risen, so has the Consumer Price Index (CPI). If elected, I will work to reduce monthly bills and increase home values through access to affordable electrification and energy efficiency programs. I will also work to lower the upfront cost of home upgrades that have a positive return on investment and improve our health by reducing exposure to gas.

Second, Piedmont would benefit from new homes. In compliance with state mandate, the Council's actions on housing have created opportunities for new development. New housing also increases diversity and grows the tax base.

Third, to raise revenue, Piedmont should explore the possibility of introducing new small businesses and support ballot measure GG, which will provide funding for Piedmont's essential services. This includes police, fire, and emergency medical response, park maintenance, and infrastructure.

If elected, I will focus on these issues. Increasing home values and lowering living expenses will be my top priority. That said, I will always carefully manage the city budget and maintain best-in-class safety and first-responder services that meet the needs and expectations of Piedmont residents.



Tom Ramsey
Incumbent

My view of the top three issues should always align with my neighbors because I don't approach my role as a councilmember with any personal agenda. In my last four years on council, I know Piedmonters are focused on community safety, fiscal responsibility, and maintaining the beauty of our town.

I tackle fiscal responsibility first because a solid financial foundation is required to deliver on any other priority. Currently, inflation and rising labor costs outpace our revenues. Since over 60% of city funding comes from a property tax base that doesn't automatically keep pace, we must manage budgets meticulously. I am committed to working collaboratively with city staff, my neighbors, and colleagues to prioritize capital projects and essential facilities, steer our new community pool operations toward full cost-recovery, and consider new revenue sources and more creative funding.

Our new emergency dispatch center serves as a perfect model. Completed on time and on budget, partially funded with federal grants, it stands as a seamless improvement to our city infrastructure — while directly enhancing community safety by maintaining rapid response times and allowing our operators to work more efficiently. I want to bring this blend of smart fiscal stewardship and community safety to all future projects in Piedmont.

Nancy Bostrom
No Response

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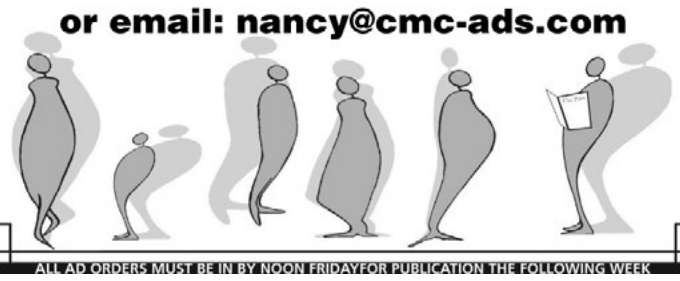
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Leslie Mendez

Continued from page 1

castically. I love challenges, and I love to do puzzles. So it's always interesting to see what every city is doing and see how it can be improved," she said.

During her time with Albany, Mendez was proud to work on housing element implementations. As a smaller city, she wore multiple hats, broadening her experience. She worked on tenants' rights, ordinances, building department collaboration, and community outreach. Mendez is excited to tackle the current challenges that face Piedmont's housing and figure out how to meet state mandates in a community that is primarily built out.

"I think, like many communities that are primarily built out, whether there is more multi-development space or not, multi-zoned. A lot of the new units are coming from primarily ADUs. That would be for us too. Secondarily, and less so, some SB9 units, some new units on the vacant lots that are there, so it's really a challenge. I think this cycle is significant no matter what jurisdiction you're in," said Mendez.

Her short-term goals for the city are to ingrain herself in the community. She believes being part of the community and hearing from residents is extremely important to her role.

"My immediate goal is really to familiarize myself with those in the community. I have only been here a month, and it's been great so far, but I want to get out more in the community. Maybe do some of those Wednesday walks," she said

During her time in Piedmont, Mendez would like to collaborate with the community on the housing element. Long-term, she'd like to update Piedmont's planning processes to the best modern practices.

"During my tenure, I would like to work closely, through public engagement, as we move forward with our housing element goals. I know the city and the community were really involved in the creation of the last housing element," Mendez continued. "I will update some of the processes here to meet the best modern practices. I feel very strongly about making information available to the public, being transparent with that information, and making sure it's presented in a way that's readable and easy to understand."

Once she settles in, Mendez plans to attend city events and meet the people that make up her new community. She says she will make time to speak with the community members and hear their grievances.

"The community can always reach me by my phone or by email. I want to meet up with folks when I can. Eventually, I'd like to go to some community events as I get more settled. You know, there's the Cops, Cars, and Coffee events. Maybe there could be gluten-free pizza with planners," Mendez said jokingly.

As Planning & Building Director, she will oversee the city's planning, building, land use, zoning, code enforcement, and sustainability functions. Mendez was drawn to Piedmont by the opportunity to work with an engaged community and to contribute to both the City's major long-range planning initiatives and the everyday services residents rely on.

Residents may contact her at 510-420-3039 or lmendez@piedmont.ca.gov.

Play School

Continued from page 1

school. They will continue to lead the classroom in its new home, bringing continuity and stability to the transition.

The new location offers a light-filled, calm and inviting setting for the school's play-based approach to early childhood learning. PPS remains the only licensed preschool of its kind in the area built around social-emotional learning as a core part of its curriculum.

A day at Piedmont Play School

Each day at PPS blends structured and child-led play, giving children space to explore, build friendships, and develop independence alongside caring, familiar teachers.

PPS's play-based, mixed-age curriculum is intentionally designed to strengthen the social and emotional skills that matter most as children grow. Mixed-age classes encourage younger children to learn from older peers and give older children opportunities to lead and mentor — building confidence, empathy, and communication skills.

Educators increasingly point to strong social-emotional foundations as a key predictor of success when children enter TK and Kindergarten, where academic and behavioral expectations have never been higher. PPS's approach is designed to help prepare children for that transition both academically and emotionally.



Teacher Michelle Ritchie has been with Piedmont Play School since 2013.

A Co-Op model built for busy families

PPS operates as a light co-op by design. Families are asked to contribute in small, manageable ways rather than large time commitments, making it possible for working parents to still be present and engaged in their child's classroom experience. Many parents describe their volunteer hours as some of the most rewarding time they spend with their kids.

For PPS President & CEO June Groboske, the co-op model is about more than the preschool. It's the starting point for a much longer relationship between families and their community.

"Our co-op model is where a lifelong connection to our school community begins," said Groboske. "PPS parents discover early on what meaningful school involvement looks like. Working side by side with teachers and other parents gives families a firsthand appreciation for the school, classroom, and community dynamics, helping parents learn how to best support teachers and students alike. That strong foundation naturally carries forward — so many of our PPS parents go on to serve as parent board officers, school committee chairs, and active community leaders throughout PUSD."

With this move to Clarewood Drive, PPS parents, alumni, and teachers preserved a philosophy of early childhood education, a group of beloved teachers, and a place where families can be genuinely involved in their children's earliest school experiences. The comfort in knowing the school will carry on, paired with genuine enthusiasm for what's ahead, has echoed throughout the PPS community as the school settles into its new space.

To learn more about PPS, please visit piedmontplayschool.org. Follow along: @piedmontplayschoolca on Instagram.



Students enter Piedmont Play School at age 2 usually with enrollment designed as a two-year experience preparing them for Transitional Kindergarten or Kindergarten.

Wednesday Walkers

Continued from page 20

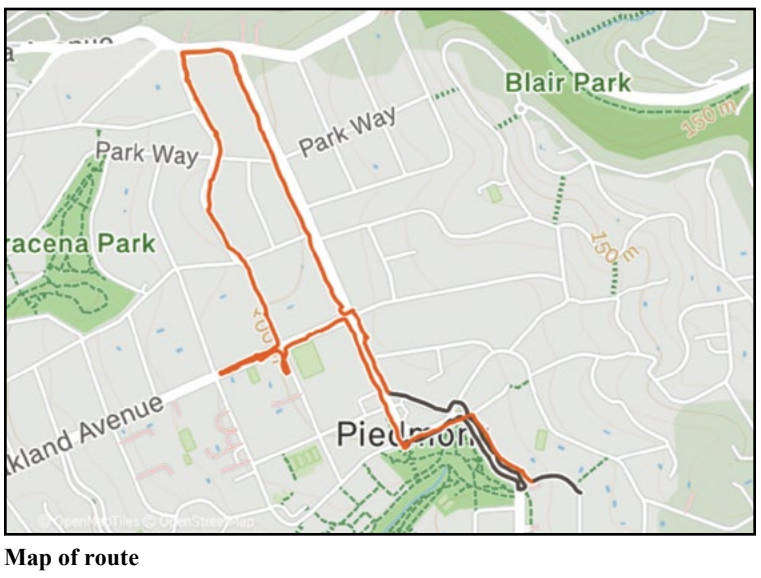
a 1910 auto fire in its garage.

Oakland Avenue offered more. 1719 Oakland is a 1905 bungalow with oxeye and stained glass windows, shingles, bays, and many additions over the years. Across the street, 1726 Oakland is a one-of-a-kind house designed by Ethel Soule, who fell ill and died within months of moving in with her husband and two boys. He didn't want the memories associated with the house, so he sold it and bought on El Cerrito Avenue.

Mary had stories, too, about the 1899 Foursquare at 311 Bonita, a twin of 141 Hillside, and the 1896 Victorian at 1811 Oakland. All of the histories confirmed that every house, and especially these beautiful Piedmont Centennials, has a story all its own.

The walkers expressed their thanks to Mary for the research she had done and shared, and returned to the Exedra via Vista Avenue, past Havens School, where the kids were on the playground for recess and having a fun morning too.

The Walking on Wednesdays group meets every week at 10:30 a.m. at the Exedra (Highland and Magnolia Avenues). The program is free and open to all, and new walkers—along with their K-9 best friends—are always welcome. Registration is required. For more information or to sign up, visit https://tinyurl.com/3ethkehu



Map of route

The *Post* online...

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Fire Dept. asks residents to complete wildfire evacuation plans

As fall begins, the Piedmont Fire Department urges residents to set aside time to complete a simple, easy-to-follow at-home wildfire evacuation exercise with their household. The exercise provides step-by-step instructions and discussion prompts in a short video that families, housemates, and neighbors can use to transform their wildfire "what ifs" into a tangible, actionable plan. The short exercise helps you spot gaps, talk through decisions, and walk away more confident about what to do if a wildfire comes.

What to expect:
- A realistic, local wildfire scenario based on conditions in Piedmont
- Simple, pause-and-discuss prompts for each stage of evacuation
- A downloadable worksheet to capture your household's plan and next steps
- A calm, supportive narrator to walk you through the process
- Total time: 30-45 minutes

Watch the video and download the worksheet at piedmont.ca.gov/WildfirePlan. Find additional wildfire preparedness resources at piedmont.ca.gov/Wildfire.

The at-home evacuation exercise is one part of the Piedmont Fire Department's broader work partnering with community members to build a safer, more resilient Piedmont. Last year, the department conducted a practical evacuation drill for the Blair/Scenic/Alta neighborhood, giving them a hands-on opportunity to test their own evacuation plans. Firefighters also provide year-round public education, coordinate training with regional partners, and offer home visits to help residents understand steps they can take to harden their properties.

The department also recently led the development of Piedmont's Local Hazard Mitigation Plan, engaging residents in a collaborative process to create a 5-year roadmap that identifies steps the city can take to reduce the effects of disasters before they happen.

Each household that completes the at-home exercise adds another layer of readiness to these efforts – strengthening not just their own plans, but our community's resilience as a whole.

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Give us 30 minutes.

We'll help you turn "we should have a plan" into a plan.

- At-home wildfire evacuation exercise
- Walk through a realistic scenario
- Simple prompts spark conversation
- Designed for families to do together
- Worksheet to capture your plan

piedmont.ca.gov/WildfirePlan

2026 Calendar of Events

September 9 - September 16

Wednesday, September 9
7:00 p.m. ..... School Board Meeting..... City Hall

Monday, September 14
5:30 p.m. ..... Planning Commission Meeting..... City Hall

Tuesday, September 15
5:30 p.m. ..... Try(it) Out Tuesdays.....Beach Playfield (333 Linda Ave)

Wednesday, September 16
7:30 p.m. ..... Recreation Commission Meeting..... City Hall

Meetings may be viewed on KCOM (Channel 27) and on the City's website: piedmont.ca.gov.

Flag Football

Continued from page 12

left before switching the opposite way. She dodged a defender about five-yards past the line of scrimmage, freeing her way to the end zone to give the Highlanders a 14-13 lead. San Leandro had just two plays on its ensuing possession to end the game.

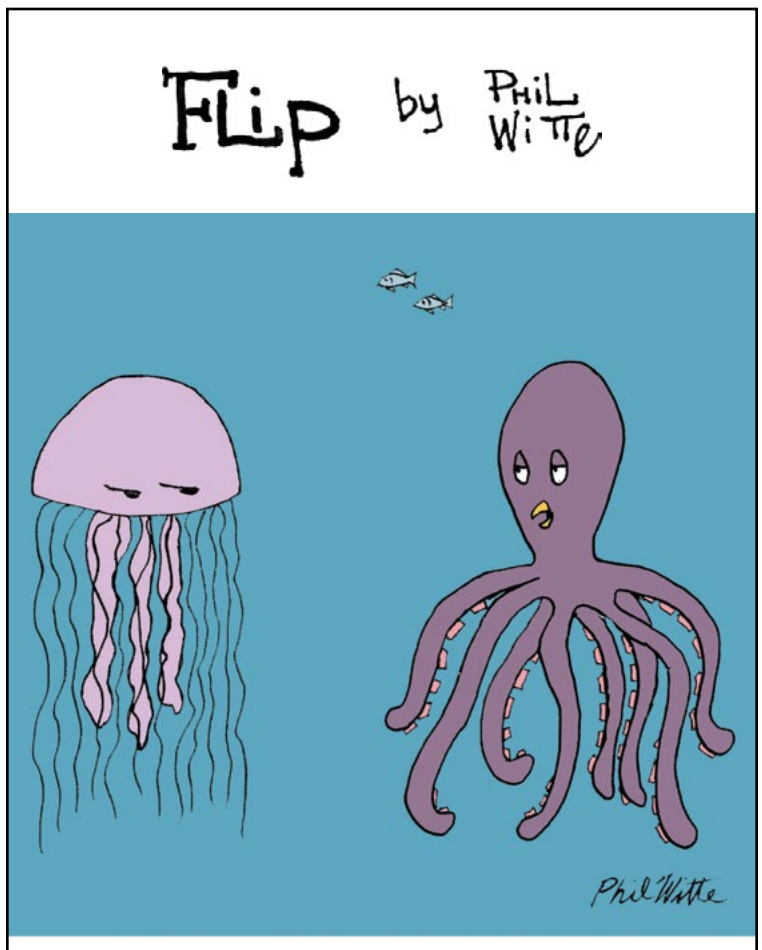
Final stats: Elmquist completed four passes for 38 yards, to go along with 57 rushing yards. Tong had one interception and three pass defenses. Alexander had one touchdown reception. Mafi had 46 rushing yards and one touchdown. Sydney Latvala had a tackle for loss and pass defense. Filha-Gama had a sack and forced safety.

Tuesday vs. American

Piedmont visited American in Fremont on Tuesday, September 8. See next week's *Post* for game details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (2-5 overall, 1-0 league) hosts Tennyson on Thursday, September 10 at 7:45 p.m.



"Quality, not quantity."

Where in the World Are We?



School board member Max Roman and Tory enjoying the *Piedmont Post* while on a tour of Rome. The couple stopped by the Colosseum in Rome and paused at the restaurant atop the Palazzo Manfreddi hotel to read the *Piedmont Post*. They then boarded a 7-day Tyrrhenian and Balearic Seas cruise for the Total Solar Eclipse on August 12.

Send your photos of the Post in the far corners of the world, or of other communities named Piedmont, to: WITWAW, 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610.